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Systems and methods for securing a continuous analyte sensor to a host

Abstract

Adhesive pad systems that provide longer lasting adherence of the mounting unit to the host's skin are provided. Some systems include a reinforcing overlay that at least partially covers the adhesive pad. The reinforcing overlay may be removable without disturbing the sensor so that the overlay may be replaceable.

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Background/Summary

INCORPORATION BY REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) Any and all priority claims identified in the Application Data Sheet, or any correction thereto, are hereby incorporated by reference under 37 CFR 1.57. This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/835,603, filed Aug. 25, 2015, which claims the benefit of priority of U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/042,170 filed Aug. 26, 2014. The aforementioned applications are incorporated by reference herein in their entireties, and are hereby expressly made a part of this specification.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present embodiments relate to systems and methods for measuring an analyte concentration in a host.

BACKGROUND

(2) Diabetes mellitus is a disorder in which the pancreas cannot create sufficient insulin (Type I or insulin dependent) and/or in which insulin is not effective (Type 2 or non-insulin dependent). In the diabetic state, the victim suffers from high blood sugar, which may cause an array of physiological derangements associated with the deterioration of small blood vessels, for example, kidney failure, skin ulcers, or bleeding into the vitreous of the eye. A hypoglycemic reaction (low blood sugar) may be induced by an inadvertent overdose of insulin, or after a normal dose of insulin or glucose-lowering agent accompanied by extraordinary exercise or insufficient food intake.

(3) Conventionally, a person with diabetes carries a self-monitoring blood glucose (SMBG) monitor, which typically requires uncomfortable finger pricks to obtain blood samples for measurement. Due to the lack of comfort and convenience associated with finger pricks, a person with diabetes normally only measures his or her glucose levels two to four times per day. Unfortunately, time intervals between measurements may be spread far enough apart that the person with diabetes finds out too late of a hyperglycemic or hypoglycemic condition, sometimes incurring dangerous side effects. It is not only unlikely that a person with diabetes will take a timely SMBG value, it is also likely that he or she will not know if his or her blood glucose value is going up (higher) or down (lower) based on conventional methods. Diabetics thus may be inhibited from making educated insulin therapy decisions.

(4) Another device that some diabetics use to monitor their blood glucose is a continuous analyte sensor. A continuous analyte sensor typically includes a sensor that is placed subcutaneously, transdermally (e.g., transcutaneously), or intravascularly. The sensor measures the concentration of a given analyte within the body, and generates a raw signal that is transmitted to electronics associated with the sensor. The raw signal is converted into an output value that is displayed on a display. The output value that results from the conversion of the raw signal is typically expressed in a form that provides the user with meaningful information, such as blood glucose expressed in mg/dL.

SUMMARY

(5) The various embodiments of the present systems and methods for securing a continuous analyte sensor to a host have several features, no single one of which is solely responsible for their desirable attributes. Without limiting the scope of the present embodiments as expressed by the claims that follow, their more prominent features now will be discussed briefly. After considering this discussion, and particularly after reading the section entitled "Detailed Description," one will understand how the features of the present embodiments provide the advantages described herein.

(6) One aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that current adhesive pads may not remain adhered to the host's skin for a desired duration. For example, when a user begins a new sensor session, it is desirable for that sensor to remain within the host for up to about seven days. In the future, the target sensor session length may be even longer, such as up to about fourteen days. Therefore, there is a need for an adhesive pad system that provides longer lasting adherence of the mounting unit to the host's skin. In some embodiments, the adherence desirably persists for about ten days to about fourteen days.

(7) In a first aspect, an adhesive pad system is provided for securing a continuous analyte sensor assembly to skin of a host, the system comprising: a housing configured to receive a sensor electronics unit; an adhesive pad having an upper surface and an undersurface, wherein the housing is secured to the upper surface of the adhesive pad, and wherein the undersurface of the adhesive pad includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the adhesive pad to the skin of the host; and a reinforcing overlay having an upper surface, an undersurface, and a central opening configured to

allow at least a portion of the housing to protrude therefrom, wherein the undersurface of the overlay includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the overlay to the adhesive pad and to the skin of the host, wherein the overlay has a larger perimeter dimension than the adhesive pad, such that the overlay extends outwardly on all sides from a periphery of the adhesive pad when the overlay is positioned over the adhesive pad with the housing protruding through the central opening, and wherein a first portion of the overlay adheres to the adhesive pad and a second portion of the overlay adheres to the skin of the host.

(8) In an embodiment of the first aspect, the first portion of the overlay comprises from about 10% to about 65% of a total area of the overlay.

(9) In an embodiment of the first aspect, the first portion of the overlay comprises from about 20% to about 55% of the total area of the overlay.

(10) In an embodiment of the first aspect, the adhesive pad has an area from about 1 square inch to about 2 square inches.

(11) In an embodiment of the first aspect, the overlay has an area from about 4 square inches to about 7 square inches.

(12) In an embodiment of the first aspect, the ultimate adhesive strength of the adhesive pad system immediately after application to a test surface is great than about 12 lbf.

(13) In an embodiment of the first aspect, the test surface is stainless steel.

(14) In an embodiment of the first aspect, application of the overlay onto the adhesive pad results in an increased adhesive strength that is from about 40% to about 45% of the adhesive strength of the adhesive pad alone.

(15) In an embodiment of the first aspect, the overlay is configured to be removed from the adhesive pad and from the skin of the host without disturbing continued operation of the sensor electronics unit.

(16) In a second aspect, a method is provided for securing a continuous analyte sensor assembly to skin of a host, the method comprising: securing the continuous analyte sensor assembly to the skin of the host, wherein the continuous analyte sensor assembly comprises a continuous analyte sensor, an adhesive pad, and a housing configured to receive a sensor electronics unit, wherein the adhesive pad comprises an upper surface and an undersurface, wherein the housing is secured to the upper surface of the adhesive pad, and wherein the undersurface of the adhesive pad includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the adhesive pad to the skin of the host; and applying a reinforcing overlay to the adhesive pad and to the skin, wherein the overlay comprises a top surface and a bottom surface, wherein the overlay includes an upper surface, an undersurface, and a central opening configured to allow at least a portion of the housing to protrude therefrom, wherein the undersurface of the overlay includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the overlay to the adhesive pad and to the skin of the host, wherein the overlay has a larger perimeter dimension than the adhesive pad, such that the overlay extends outwardly on all sides from a periphery of the adhesive pad when the overlay is positioned over the adhesive pad with the housing protruding through the central opening, and wherein a first portion of the overlay adheres to the adhesive pad and a second portion of the overlay adheres to the skin of the host.

(17) In an embodiment of the second aspect, the first portion of the overlay comprises from about 10% to about 65% of a total area of the overlay.

(18) In an embodiment of the second aspect, the first portion of the overlay comprises from about 20% to about 55% of a total area of the overlay.

(19) In an embodiment of the second aspect, the adhesive pad has an area from about 1 square inch to about 2 square inches.

(20) In an embodiment of the second aspect, the overlay has an area from about 4 square inches to about 7 square inches.

(21) In a third aspect, an adhesive pad system is provided for securing a continuous analyte sensor assembly to skin of a host, the system comprising: a housing configured to receive a sensor

electronics unit; a frame configured to receive the housing, the frame including a lip that is sized and shaped to receive the housing with the lip extending around the outer edges of the housing, and a flange extending radially outward from a lower end of the lip; and a reinforcing overlay having an upper surface, an undersurface, and a central opening configured to allow at least a portion of the housing and at least a portion of the frame to protrude therefrom, wherein the undersurface of the overlay includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the overlay to the flange and to the skin of the host, wherein the overlay has a larger perimeter dimension than the flange, such that the overlay extends outwardly on all sides from a periphery of the flange when the overlay is positioned over the frame, and wherein a first portion of the overlay adheres to the flange and a second portion of the overlay adheres to the skin of the host.

(22) In an embodiment of the third aspect, the housing comprises a planar bottom wall and a lip that extends around a periphery of the bottom wall.

(23) In an embodiment of the third aspect, the bottom wall includes an opening to accommodate a sensor of the sensor assembly.

(24) In an embodiment of the third aspect, the flange of the frame includes texturing that provides improved breathability.

(25) In a fourth aspect, an adhesive pad system is provided for securing a continuous analyte sensor assembly to skin of a host, the system comprising: a housing configured to receive a sensor electronics unit; an adhesive layer configured to adhere to the host's skin, the adhesive layer having an upper surface and an undersurface, wherein the undersurface of the adhesive layer includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the adhesive layer to the skin of the host; and a cushioning layer configured to adhere to the adhesive layer, the cushioning layer having an upper surface and an undersurface, wherein the undersurface of the cushioning layer includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the cushioning layer to the upper surface of the adhesive layer, the cushioning layer further having a first thickness.

(26) In an embodiment of the fourth aspect, the adhesive layer has a second thickness that is less than the first thickness, and the adhesive layer has a larger perimeter dimension than the cushioning layer, such that the adhesive layer extends outwardly on all sides from a periphery of the cushioning layer when the cushioning layer is positioned over the adhesive layer.

(27) In an embodiment of the fourth aspect, the adhesive pad system comprises a layer of double-sided tape configured to be interposed between the adhesive layer and the sensor electronics unit housing.

(28) In an embodiment of the fourth aspect, the double-sided tape has a smaller perimeter dimension than both the overlay and the cushioning layer.

(29) In an embodiment of the fourth aspect, the upper surface of the cushioning layer abuts and adheres to a bottom surface of the electronics unit housing.

(30) In an embodiment of the fourth aspect, the housing comprises a planar bottom wall and a lip that extends around a periphery of the bottom wall.

(31) In an embodiment of the fourth aspect, the bottom wall includes an opening to accommodate a sensor of the sensor assembly.

(32) In an embodiment of the fourth aspect, the cushioning layer, and the adhesive layer, each include at least one opening, and the openings in the cushioning layer and the adhesive layer align with one another and with the opening in the bottom wall of the housing.

(33) In a fifth aspect, an adhesive pad system is provided for securing a continuous analyte sensor assembly to skin of a host, the system comprising: a housing configured to receive a sensor electronics unit; an adhesive pad having an upper surface and an undersurface, wherein the housing is secured to the upper surface of the adhesive pad, and wherein the undersurface of the adhesive pad includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the adhesive pad to the skin of the host; and a reinforcing overlay configured to cover the adhesive pad, the overlay having an upper surface, an undersurface, and a central opening configured to allow at least a portion of the housing to protrude

therefrom, wherein the undersurface of the overlay includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the overlay to the adhesive pad and to the skin of the host, the overlay further having a larger perimeter dimension than the adhesive pad, such that the overlay extends outwardly on all sides from a periphery of the adhesive pad when the overlay is positioned over the adhesive pad, wherein the overlay includes perforations that mark a boundary between a first radially outward portion and a second inner portion.

(34) In an embodiment of the fifth aspect, the perforations facilitate removal of the first radially outward portion from the adhesive pad system without disturbing the adhesive pad.

(35) In an embodiment of the fifth aspect, a path traced by the perforations is substantially the same size and shape as the periphery of the adhesive pad.

(36) In a sixth aspect, a method is provided for securing a continuous analyte sensor assembly to skin of a host, the method comprising: securing the continuous analyte sensor assembly to the skin of the host, wherein the continuous analyte sensor assembly comprises a continuous analyte sensor, an adhesive pad, and a housing configured to receive a sensor electronics unit, wherein the adhesive pad comprises an upper surface and an undersurface, wherein the housing is secured to the upper surface of the adhesive pad, and wherein the undersurface of the adhesive pad includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the adhesive pad to the skin of the host; applying a reinforcing overlay to the adhesive pad and to the skin, wherein the overlay includes an upper surface, an undersurface, and a central opening configured to allow at least a portion of the housing to protrude therefrom, wherein the undersurface of the overlay includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the overlay to the adhesive pad and to the skin of the host, wherein the overlay has a larger perimeter dimension than the adhesive pad, such that the overlay extends outwardly on all sides from a periphery of the adhesive pad when the overlay is positioned over the adhesive pad with the housing protruding through the central opening, and wherein the overlay includes perforations that mark a boundary between a first radially outward portion and a second inner portion; and removing the first radially outward portion of the overlay without removing the second inner portion by tearing the overlay along the perforations.

(37) In an embodiment of the sixth aspect, the overlay comprises a first overlay, the method further comprising applying a second reinforcing overlay over the second inner portion of the first overlay and to the skin of the host.

(38) In an embodiment of the sixth aspect, the second overlay includes an upper surface, an undersurface, and a central opening configured to allow at least a portion of the housing to protrude therefrom, wherein the undersurface of the second overlay includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the second overlay to the second inner portion of the first overlay and to the skin of the host.

(39) In an embodiment of the sixth aspect, the second overlay includes perforations that mark a boundary between a first radially outward portion and a second inner portion.

(40) In a seventh aspect, an adhesive pad system is provided for securing a continuous analyte sensor assembly to skin of a host, the system comprising: a housing configured to receive a sensor electronics unit; and an adhesive pad having an upper surface, wherein the housing is secured to the upper surface of the adhesive pad, and wherein the adhesive pad includes a plurality of layers, and each of the layers includes an undersurface having an adhesive material configured to adhere the adhesive pad to the skin of the host, and wherein the adhesive material on each of the layers has a different strength.

(41) In an embodiment of the seventh aspect, the adhesive pad comprises an innermost layer, an outermost layer, and an intermediate layer.

(42) In an embodiment of the seventh aspect, the innermost layer has a weakest adhesive material, the outermost layer has a strongest adhesive material, and the intermediate layer has an adhesive material with a strength between the weakest adhesive material and the strongest adhesive material.

(43) In an embodiment of the seventh aspect, the innermost layer has a strongest adhesive material,

the outermost layer has a weakest adhesive material, and the intermediate layer has an adhesive material with a strength between the weakest adhesive material and the strongest adhesive material.
(44) In an embodiment of the seventh aspect, each of the layers is covered with a removable backing.

(45) In an embodiment of the seventh aspect, each of the removable backings includes a pull-tab at its periphery.

(46) In an eighth aspect, a method is provided for securing a continuous analyte sensor assembly onto skin of a host, the method comprising: receiving the continuous analyte sensor assembly, wherein the continuous analyte sensor assembly comprises a housing configured to receive a sensor electronics unit; and an adhesive pad having an upper surface, wherein the housing is secured to the upper surface of the adhesive pad, and wherein the adhesive pad includes a plurality of layers, and each of the layers includes an undersurface having an adhesive material configured to adhere the adhesive pad to the skin of the host, wherein the adhesive material on each of the layers has a different strength, and wherein each of the layers is covered with a removable backing; wherein the method comprises peeling off a first one of the removable backings and adhering the adhesive pad to the host's skin without peeling off a second one of the removable backings.

(47) In an embodiment of the eighth aspect, the adhesive pad comprises an innermost layer, an outermost layer, and an intermediate layer.

(48) In an embodiment of the eighth aspect, the innermost layer has a weakest adhesive material, the outermost layer has a strongest adhesive material, and the intermediate layer has an adhesive material with a strength between the weakest adhesive material and the strongest adhesive material.

(49) In an embodiment of the eighth aspect, the innermost layer has a strongest adhesive material, the outermost layer has a weakest adhesive material, and the intermediate layer has an adhesive material with a strength between the weakest adhesive material and the strongest adhesive material.

(50) In a ninth aspect, a continuous analyte sensor system is provided, the system comprising: a continuous analyte sensor; a mounting unit configured to be placed on skin of a host, the mounting unit including an adhesive pad and a housing secured to an upper surface of the adhesive pad, wherein the adhesive pad includes an undersurface having an adhesive material configured to adhere to the host's skin; and an inserter configured to insert the continuous analyte sensor into the host, wherein the continuous analyte sensor is disposed within the inserter prior to sensor insertion, and wherein the inserter is configured to be secured to the housing of the mounting unit during sensor insertion; wherein the mounting unit is adapted to undergo a different sterilization process than the inserter and/or the continuous analyte sensor.

(51) In a tenth aspect, a method is provided for inserting a continuous analyte sensor into a host, the method comprising: applying a mounting unit onto skin, wherein the mounting unit comprises an adhesive pad and a housing secured to an upper surface of the adhesive pad, wherein the adhesive pad includes an undersurface having an adhesive material configured to adhere to the host's skin; securing an inserter to the housing of the mounting unit, wherein the continuous analyte sensor is disposed within the inserter prior to sensor insertion, and wherein the mounting unit is not sterilized prior to sensor insertion; and activating the inserter to insert the continuous analyte sensor into the host.

(52) In an eleventh aspect, an adhesive pad system is provided for securing a continuous analyte sensor assembly to skin of a host, the system comprising: a housing configured to receive a sensor electronics unit; an adhesive pad having an upper surface and an undersurface, wherein the housing is secured to the upper surface of the adhesive pad, wherein the undersurface of the adhesive pad includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the adhesive pad to the skin of the host, and wherein the adhesive pad comprises a first material; and a reinforcing overlay having an upper surface, an undersurface, and a central opening configured to allow at least a portion of the housing to protrude therefrom, wherein the undersurface of the overlay includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the overlay to the adhesive pad and to the skin of the host, and wherein the

overlay comprises a second material.

(53) In an embodiment of the eleventh aspect, the first material is a fabric and the second material is a polymer.

(54) In a twelfth aspect, an adhesive pad system is provided for securing a continuous analyte sensor assembly to skin of a host, the system comprising: a housing configured to receive a sensor electronics unit; and an adhesive pad having an upper surface and an undersurface, wherein the housing is secured to the upper surface of the adhesive pad, wherein the undersurface of the adhesive pad includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the adhesive pad to the skin of the host; wherein a perimeter edge of the adhesive pad includes a reduced thickness relative to an interior portion of the adhesive pad.

(55) In an embodiment of the twelfth aspect, the perimeter edge has a thickness that is from about 5% to about 95% of the thickness of the interior portion.

(56) In an embodiment of the twelfth aspect, the perimeter edge has a thickness that is from about 10% to about 80% of the thickness of the interior portion.

(57) In an embodiment of the twelfth aspect, the perimeter edge has a thickness that is from about 25% to about 75% of the thickness of the interior portion.

(58) In an embodiment of the twelfth aspect, the perimeter edge has a thickness that is from about 33% to about 50% of the thickness of the interior portion.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The various embodiments of the present systems and methods for securing a continuous analyte sensor to a host now will be discussed in detail with an emphasis on highlighting the advantageous features. These embodiments depict the novel and non-obvious systems and methods for securing a continuous analyte sensor to a host shown in the accompanying drawings, which are for illustrative purposes only. These drawings are not necessarily drawn to scale, and they are provided merely to illustrate the present embodiments. These drawings include the following figures, in which like numerals indicate like parts:

(2) FIG. 1 is a schematic view of a continuous analyte sensor system attached to a host and communicating with other devices;

(3) FIG. 2 is a partially exploded upper perspective view of one embodiment of an adhesive sensor system including a replaceable reinforcing overlay;

(4) FIG. 3 is an assembled upper perspective view of the adhesive sensor system of FIG. 2;

(5) FIG. 4 is a partially exploded upper perspective view of another embodiment of an adhesive sensor system including a replaceable reinforcing overlay;

(6) FIG. 5 is an assembled upper perspective view of the adhesive sensor system of FIG. 4;

(7) FIG. 6 is an exploded upper perspective view of one embodiment of an adhesive sensor system including a multilayer adhesive pad;

(8) FIG. 7 is an assembled upper perspective view of the adhesive sensor system of FIG. 6;

(9) FIG. 8 is an exploded upper perspective view of another embodiment of an adhesive sensor system including a multilayer adhesive pad;

(10) FIG. 9 is an assembled upper perspective view of the adhesive sensor system of FIG. 8;

(11) FIG. 10 is an exploded upper perspective view of another embodiment of a multilayer adhesive pad for an adhesive sensor system;

(12) FIG. 11 is an assembled upper perspective view of the multilayer adhesive pad of FIG. 10;

(13) FIG. 12 is a partially exploded upper perspective view of the multilayer adhesive pad of FIG. 11 and a housing for a sensor electronics unit;

(14) FIG. 13 is an assembled upper perspective view of the multilayer adhesive pad and the

housing of FIG. 12;

(15) FIG. 14A is an exploded upper perspective view of another embodiment of a multilayer adhesive pad for an adhesive sensor system;

(16) FIG. 14B is an exploded upper perspective view of still another embodiment of a multilayer adhesive pad for an adhesive sensor system;

(17) FIG. 15 is an assembled upper perspective view of the multilayer adhesive pad of FIG. 14A;

(18) FIG. 16 is a partially exploded upper perspective view of the multilayer adhesive pad of FIG. 15 and a housing for a sensor electronics unit;

(19) FIG. 17 is an assembled upper perspective view of the multilayer adhesive pad and the housing of FIG. 16;

(20) FIG. 18 is an exploded upper perspective view of another embodiment of a multilayer adhesive pad for an adhesive sensor system;

(21) FIG. 19 is an assembled upper perspective view of the multilayer adhesive pad of FIG. 18;

(22) FIG. 20 is a partially exploded upper perspective view of the multilayer adhesive pad of FIG. 19 and a housing for a sensor electronics unit;

(23) FIG. 21 is an assembled upper perspective view of the multilayer adhesive pad and the housing of FIG. 20;

(24) FIGS. 22-25 are schematic top plan views of one embodiment of an adhesive sensor system including a perforated overlay;

(25) FIG. 26 is a schematic top plan view of one embodiment of an adhesive pad and overlay combination;

(26) FIG. 27 is a schematic bottom plan view of another embodiment of a multilayer adhesive pad for an adhesive sensor system;

(27) FIG. 28 is a schematic bottom plan view of one embodiment of an adhesive pad and sensor electronics unit housing combination;

(28) FIG. 29 is an exploded upper perspective view of another embodiment of an adhesive sensor system;

(29) FIG. 30 is a partial cross-sectional view of one embodiment of an adhesive sensor system including a cover;

(30) FIG. 31 is a partial cross-sectional view of another embodiment of an adhesive sensor system including a cover;

(31) FIG. 32 is a partial cross-sectional view of another embodiment of an adhesive sensor system including a cover;

(32) FIG. 33 is a schematic top plan view of one embodiment of an adhesive pad for an adhesive sensor system, the adhesive pad having a plurality of channels for enabling outflow of moisture;

(33) FIG. 34 is a cross-sectional view of the adhesive pad of FIG. 33, taken through the line 34-34 in FIG. 33;

(34) FIGS. 35-40 are schematic side elevation views of one embodiment of an applicator device for an adhesive pad of an adhesive sensor system, showing successive stages of a process for securing the adhesive pad to a host's skin using the applicator device;

(35) FIG. 41A is an exploded perspective view of the overlay assembly;

(36) FIG. 41B is an assembled perspective of the overlay assembly of FIG. 41A.

(37) FIGS. 41C1-C4 illustrate a method for applying an adhesive pad onto a skin;

(38) FIGS. 42A-B illustrate results from tests conducted to determine the adhesive strength of adhesive pads, as compared to the strength of adhesive pads reinforced with overlays;

(39) FIG. 43A-B are cross-sectionals view of one embodiment of a multi-adhesive-layer adhesive pad;

(40) FIG. 43C is a top view of the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 43A;

(41) FIG. 43D is a bottom view of the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 43A.

(42) FIG. 44A is an exploded upper perspective view of one embodiment of an adhesive sensor

- system including electronics unit housing with a channel system formed in its bottom surface;
- (43) FIG. 44B is perspective view of the bottom surface of the electronics unit housing illustrated in FIG. 44A;
- (44) FIG. 45 is an exploded upper perspective view of another embodiment of an adhesive sensor system including a multilayer adhesive pad;
- (45) FIG. 46A is an exploded upper perspective view of an assembly comprising an adhesive sensor system and a liner system;
- (46) FIG. 46B is an assembled upper perspective view of the assembly illustrated in FIG. 46A;
- (47) FIG. 46C is an assembled upper perspective view of the assembly illustrated in FIG. 46B after a first bottom liner has been removed;
- (48) FIG. 46D is an assembled upper perspective view of the assembly illustrated in FIG. 46C after a second bottom liner has been removed; and
- (49) FIG. 46E is an assembled upper perspective view of the assembly illustrated in FIG. 46B after all the liners have been removed.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (50) The following detailed description describes the present embodiments with reference to the drawings. In the drawings, reference numbers label elements of the present embodiments. These reference numbers are reproduced below in connection with the discussion of the corresponding drawing features.
- (51) The embodiments of the present systems and methods for securing a continuous analyte sensor to a host are described below with reference to the figures. These figures, and their written descriptions, indicate that certain components of the apparatus are formed integrally, and certain other components are formed as separate pieces. Those of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate that components shown and described herein as being formed integrally may in alternative embodiments be formed as separate pieces. Those of ordinary skill in the art will further appreciate that components shown and described herein as being formed as separate pieces may in alternative embodiments be formed integrally. Further, as used herein the term integral describes a single unitary piece.
- (52) The present embodiments include methods of securing a continuous analyte sensor to a host. Some of these embodiments may be performed in connection with treating a human and/or animal body. Others of these embodiments may be performed independently of a human and/or animal body, such as for purposes of testing or demonstration. Accordingly, the present embodiments pertaining to methods of securing a continuous analyte sensor to a host should not be construed as limited to methods of treating a human and/or animal body.
- (53) Sensor
- (54) The preferred embodiments relate to the use of an analyte sensor that measures a concentration of glucose or a substance indicative of the concentration or presence of an analyte. In some embodiments, the analyte sensor is a continuous device, for example a subcutaneous, transdermal, transcutaneous, and/or intravascular (e.g., intravenous) device. In some embodiments, the device can analyze a plurality of intermittent blood samples. The analyte sensor can use any method of glucose-measurement, including enzymatic, chemical, physical, electrochemical, optical, optochemical, fluorescence-based, spectrophotometric, spectroscopic (e.g., optical absorption spectroscopy, Raman spectroscopy, etc.), polarimetric, calorimetric, iontophoretic, radiometric, and the like.
- (55) The analyte sensor can use any known method, including invasive, minimally invasive, and non-invasive sensing techniques, to provide a data stream indicative of the concentration of the analyte in a host. The data stream is typically a raw data signal that is used to provide a useful value of the analyte to a user, such as a patient or health care professional (e.g., doctor), who may be using the sensor.
- (56) Although much of the description and examples are drawn to a glucose sensor, the systems and

methods of the preferred embodiments can be applied to any measurable analyte. In some preferred embodiments, the analyte sensor is a glucose sensor capable of measuring the concentration of glucose in a host. One example embodiment is described below, which utilizes an implantable glucose sensor. However, it should be understood that the devices and methods described herein can be applied to any device capable of detecting a concentration of analyte and providing an output signal that represents the concentration of the analyte.

(57) In one preferred embodiment, the analyte sensor is an implantable glucose sensor, such as described with reference to U.S. Pat. No. 6,001,067 and U.S. Patent Application Publication No. 2011/0027127. In another preferred embodiment, the analyte sensor is a transcutaneous glucose sensor, such as described with reference to U.S. Patent Application Publication No. 2006/0020187. In yet another preferred embodiment, the analyte sensor is a dual electrode analyte sensor, such as described with reference to U.S. Patent Application Publication No. 2009/0137887. In still other embodiments, the sensor is configured to be implanted in a host vessel or extracorporeally, such as is described in U.S. Patent Application Publication No. 2007/0027385.

(58) Deposition Techniques

(59) The membrane system can be deposited on the exposed electroactive surfaces using any of a variety of known thin film techniques (for example, vapor deposition, spraying, printing (e.g., pad printing), electro-depositing, dipping, sputtering deposition, spin coating, powder coating, and the like). In alternative embodiments, however, other vapor deposition processes (e.g., physical and/or chemical vapor deposition processes) can be useful for providing one or more of the insulating and/or membrane layers, including ultrasonic vapor deposition, electrostatic deposition, evaporative deposition, deposition by sputtering, pulsed laser deposition, high velocity oxygen fuel deposition, thermal evaporator deposition, electron beam evaporator deposition, deposition by reactive sputtering molecular beam epitaxy, atmospheric pressure chemical vapor deposition (CVD), atomic layer CVD, hot wire CVD, low-pressure CVD, microwave plasma-assisted CVD, plasma-enhanced CVD, rapid thermal CVD, remote plasma-enhanced CVD, and ultra-high vacuum CVD, for example. However, the membrane system can be disposed over (or deposited on) the electroactive surfaces using any known method, as will be appreciated by one skilled in the art.

(60) Analyte List

(61) The term “analyte” as used herein is a broad term, and is to be given its ordinary and customary meaning to a person of ordinary skill in the art (and it is not to be limited to a special or customized meaning), and refers without limitation to a substance or chemical constituent in a biological fluid (for example, blood, interstitial fluid, cerebral spinal fluid, lymph fluid or urine) that can be analyzed. Analytes may include naturally occurring substances, artificial substances, metabolites, and/or reaction products. In some embodiments, the analyte for measurement by the sensor heads, devices, and methods disclosed herein is glucose. However, other analytes are contemplated as well, including but not limited to lactate or lactic acid; cardiac markers; ketone bodies; acetone; acetoacetic acid; beta hydroxybutyric acid; glucagon, acetyl Co A; intermediaries in the Citric Acid Cycle; choline, testosterone; creatinine; triglycerides; sodium; potassium; chloride; bicarbonate; total protein; alkaline phosphatase; calcium; phosphorus; PO₂; PCO₂; bilirubin (direct and total); red blood cell count; white blood cell count; hemoglobin; hematocrit; lymphocytes; monocytes; eosinophils; basophils; c-reactive protein; cryoglobulins; fibrinogens; ACTH; aldosterone; ammonia; beta-HCG; magnesium; copper; iron; total cholesterol; low density lipoproteins; high density lipoproteins; lipoprotein A; T4 (total and free); TSH; FSH; LH; ACTH; hepatitis BE antigen; hepatitis B surface antigen; hepatitis A antibody; hepatitis C antibody; acarboxyprothrombin; acylcarnitine; adenine phosphoribosyl transferase; adenosine deaminase; albumin; alpha-fetoprotein; amino acid profiles (arginine (Krebs cycle), histidine/urocanic acid, homocysteine, phenylalanine/tyrosine, tryptophan); androstenedione; antipyrine; arabinitol enantiomers; arginase; benzoylecgonine (cocaine); biotinidase; biopterin; c-reactive protein; carnitine; carnosinase; CD4; ceruloplasmin; chenodeoxycholic acid; chloroquine;

cholesterol; cholinesterase; conjugated 1- β hydroxy-cholic acid; cortisol; cortisone, creatine kinase; creatine kinase MM isoenzyme; cyclosporin A; d-penicillamine; de-ethylchloroquine; dehydroepiandrosterone sulfate; DNA (acetylator polymorphism, alcohol dehydrogenase, epinephrine, alpha 1-antitrypsin, cystic fibrosis, Duchenne/Becker muscular dystrophy, analyte-6-phosphate dehydrogenase, hemoglobinopathies A, S, C, and E, D-Punjab, beta-thalassemia, hepatitis B virus, HCMV, HIV-1, HTLV-1, Leber hereditary optic neuropathy, MCAD, RNA, PKU, *Plasmodium vivax*, sexual differentiation, 21-deoxycortisol); desbutylhalofantrine; dihydropteridine reductase; diphtheria/tetanus antitoxin; erythrocyte arginase; erythrocyte protoporphyrin; esterase D; fatty acids/acylglycines; free β -human chorionic gonadotropin; free erythrocyte porphyrin; free thyroxine (FT4); free tri-iodothyronine (FT3); fumarylacetoacetase; galactose/gal-1-phosphate; galactose-1-phosphate uridyltransferase; gentamicin; analyte-6-phosphate dehydrogenase; glutathione; glutathione peroxidase; glycocholic acid; glycosylated hemoglobin; halofantrine; hemoglobin variants; hexosaminidase A; human erythrocyte carbonic anhydrase I; 17 alpha-hydroxyprogesterone; hypoxanthine phosphoribosyl transferase; immunoreactive trypsin; lactate; lead; lipoproteins ((a), B/A-1, β); lysozyme; mefloquine; netilmicin; phenobarbitone; phenytoin; phytanic/pristanic acid; progesterone; prolactin; prolidase; purine nucleoside phosphorylase; quinine; reverse tri-iodothyronine (rT3); selenium; serum pancreatic lipase; sissomicin; somatomedin C; specific antibodies (adenovirus, anti-nuclear antibody, anti-zeta antibody, arbovirus, Aujeszky's disease virus, dengue virus, *Dracunculus medinensis*, *Echinococcus granulosus*, *Entamoeba histolytica*, enterovirus, *Giardia duodenalis*, *Helicobacter pylori*, hepatitis B virus, herpes virus, HIV-1, IgE (atopic disease), influenza virus, *Leishmania donovani*, leptospira, measles/mumps/rubella, *Mycobacterium leprae*, *Mycoplasma pneumoniae*, Myoglobin, *Onchocerca volvulus*, parainfluenza virus, *Plasmodium falciparum*, poliovirus, *Pseudomonas aeruginosa*, respiratory syncytial virus, *rickettsia* (scrub typhus), *Schistosoma mansoni*, *Toxoplasma gondii*, *Trepenoma pallidum*, *Trypanosoma cruzi/rangeli*, vesicular stomatis virus, *Wuchereria bancrofti*, yellow fever virus); specific antigens (hepatitis B virus, HIV-1); succinylacetone; sulfadoxine; theophylline; thyrotropin (TSH); thyroxine (T4); thyroxine-binding globulin; trace elements; transferrin; UDP-galactose-4-epimerase; urea; uroporphyrinogen I synthase; vitamin A; white blood cells; and zinc protoporphyrin. Salts, sugar, protein, fat, vitamins, and hormones naturally occurring in blood or interstitial fluids may also constitute analytes in certain embodiments. The analyte may be naturally present in the biological fluid, for example, a metabolic product, a hormone, an antigen, an antibody, and the like. Alternatively, the analyte may be introduced into the body, for example, a contrast agent for imaging, a radioisotope, a chemical agent, a fluorocarbon-based synthetic blood, or a drug or pharmaceutical composition, including but not limited to insulin; ethanol; cannabis (marijuana, tetrahydrocannabinol, hashish); inhalants (nitrous oxide, amyl nitrite, butyl nitrite, chlorohydrocarbons, hydrocarbons); cocaine (crack cocaine); stimulants (amphetamines, methamphetamines, Ritalin, Cylert, Preludin, Didrex, PreState, Voranil, Sandrex, Plegine); depressants (barbiturates, methaqualone, tranquilizers such as Valium, Librium, Miltown, Serax, Equanil, Tranxene); hallucinogens (phencyclidine, lysergic acid, mescaline, peyote, psilocybin); narcotics (heroin, codeine, morphine, opium, meperidine, Percocet, Percodan, Tussionex, Fentanyl, Darvon, Talwin, Lomotil); designer drugs (analogs of fentanyl, meperidine, amphetamines, methamphetamines, and phencyclidine, for example, Ecstasy); anabolic steroids; and nicotine. The metabolic products of drugs and pharmaceutical compositions are also contemplated analytes. Analytes such as neurochemicals and other chemicals generated within the body may also be analyzed, such as, for example, ascorbic acid, uric acid, dopamine, noradrenaline, 3-methoxytyramine (3MT), 3,4-dihydroxyphenylacetic acid (DOPAC), homovanillic acid (HVA), 5-hydroxytryptamine (5HT), and 5-hydroxyindoleacetic acid (FHIAA).

(62) High-Level CGM System Description

(63) For illustrative purposes, reference will now be made to FIG. 1, which is an example environment in which some embodiments described herein may be implemented. Here, an analyte

monitoring system **100** includes a continuous analyte sensor system **8**. Continuous analyte sensor system **8** includes a sensor electronics module **12** and a continuous analyte sensor **10**. The system **100** can also include other devices and/or sensors, such as a medicament delivery pump **2** and a reference analyte meter **4**, as illustrated in FIG. **1**. The continuous analyte sensor **10** may be physically connected to sensor electronics module **12** and may be integral with (e.g., non-releasably attached to) or releasably attachable to the continuous analyte sensor **10**. Alternatively, the continuous analyte sensor **10** may be physically separate to sensor electronics module **12**, but electronically coupled via inductive coupling or the like. Further, the sensor electronics module **12**, medicament delivery pump **2**, and/or analyte reference meter **4** may communicate with one or more additional devices, such as any or all of display devices **14**, **16**, **18**, **20**, and **21**.

(64) The system **100** of FIG. **1** also includes a cloud-based processor **22** configured to analyze analyte data, medicament delivery data, and/or other patient related data provided over network **24** directly or indirectly from one or more of sensor system **8**, medicament delivery pump **2**, reference analyte meter **4**, and display devices **14-21**. Based on the received data, the processor **22** can further process the data, generate reports providing statistic based on the processed data, trigger notifications to electronic devices associated with the host or caretaker of the host, or provide processed information to any of the other devices of FIG. **1**. In some example implementations, the cloud-based processor **22** comprises one or more servers. If the cloud-based processor **22** comprises multiple servers, the servers can be either geographically local or separate from one another. The network **24** can include any wired and wireless communication medium to transmit data, including WiFi networks, cellular networks, the Internet and any combinations thereof.

(65) Although the example implementation described with respect to FIG. **1** refers to analyte data being received by processor **22**, other types of data processed and raw data may be received as well.

(66) In some example implementations, the sensor electronics module **12** may include electronic circuitry associated with measuring and processing data generated by the continuous analyte sensor **10**. This generated continuous analyte sensor data may also include algorithms, which can be used to process and calibrate the continuous analyte sensor data, although these algorithms may be provided in other ways as well. The sensor electronics module **12** may include hardware, firmware, software, or a combination thereof to provide measurement of levels of the analyte via a continuous analyte sensor, such as a continuous glucose sensor.

(67) The sensor electronics module **12** may, as noted, couple (e.g., wirelessly and the like) with one or more devices, such as any or all of display devices **14**, **16**, **18**, **20**, and **21**. The display devices **14**, **16**, **18**, **20**, and/or **21** may be configured for processing and presenting information, such sensor information transmitted by the sensor electronics module **12** for display at the display device. The display devices **14**, **16**, **18**, **20**, and **21** can also trigger alarms based on the analyte sensor data.

(68) In FIG. **1**, display device **14** is a key fob-like display device, display device **16** is a hand-held application-specific computing device **16** (e.g. the DexCom G4® Platinum receiver commercially available from DexCom, Inc.), display device **18** is a general purpose smart phone or tablet computing device **20** (e.g. an Apple® iPhone®, iPad®, or iPod Touch® commercially available from Apple, Inc.), display device **20** is a computer workstation **20**, and display device **21** is any wearable. In some example implementations, the relatively small, key fob-like display device **14** may be a computing device embodied in a wrist watch, a belt, a necklace, a pendent, a piece of jewelry, an adhesive pad, a pager, a key fob, a plastic card (e.g., credit card), an identification (ID) card, and/or the like. This small display device **14** may include a relatively small display (e.g., smaller than the display device **18**) and may be configured to display a limited set of displayable sensor information, such as a numerical value **26** and/or an arrow **28**. In contrast, display devices **16**, **18**, and **20** can be larger display devices that can be capable of displaying a larger set of displayable information, such as a trend graph **30** depicted on the hand-held receiver **16** in addition to other information such as a numerical value and arrow.

(69) Any other user equipment (e.g. computing devices) configured to at least present information (e.g., a medicament delivery information, discrete self-monitoring analyte readings, heart rate monitor, caloric intake monitor, and the like) can be used in addition to or instead of those discussed with reference to FIG. 1.

(70) In some example implementations of FIG. 1, the continuous analyte sensor **10** comprises a sensor for detecting and/or measuring analytes, and the continuous analyte sensor **10** may be configured to continuously detect and/or measure analytes as a non-invasive device, a subcutaneous device, a transdermal device, and/or an intravascular device. In some example implementations, the continuous analyte sensor **10** may analyze a plurality of intermittent blood samples, although other analytes may be used as well.

(71) In some example implementations of FIG. 1, the continuous analyte sensor **10** may comprise a glucose sensor configured to measure glucose in the blood using one or more measurement techniques, such as enzymatic, chemical, physical, electrochemical, spectrophotometric, polarimetric, calorimetric, iontophoretic, radiometric, immunochemical, and the like. In implementations in which the continuous analyte sensor **10** includes a glucose sensor, the glucose sensor may be comprised of any device capable of measuring the concentration of glucose and may use a variety of techniques to measure glucose including invasive, minimally invasive, and non-invasive sensing techniques (e.g., fluorescent monitoring), to provide a data, such as a data stream, indicative of the concentration of glucose in a host. The data stream may be raw data signal, which is converted into a calibrated and/or filtered data stream used to provide a value of glucose to a host, such as a user, a patient, or a caretaker (e.g., a parent, a relative, a guardian, a teacher, a doctor, a nurse, or any other individual that has an interest in the wellbeing of the host). Moreover, the continuous analyte sensor **10** may be implanted as at least one of the following types of sensors: an implantable glucose sensor, a transcutaneous glucose sensor, implanted in a host vessel or extracorporeally, a subcutaneous sensor, a refillable subcutaneous sensor, an intravascular sensor.

(72) In some implementations of FIG. 1, the continuous analyte sensor system **8** includes a DexCom G4® Platinum glucose sensor and transmitter commercially available from DexCom, Inc., for continuously monitoring a host's glucose levels.

(73) Adhesion to the Host

(74) One aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that current adhesive pads with the mounting units (i.e., the sensor assembly disposed on the adhesive pad, including, for example, the sensor electronics housing, the sensor electronics, etc.) adhered thereon may not remain adhered to the host's skin for a desired duration. In fact, issues relating to the adhesive pad adhering to the skin are some of the primary factors that result in shortened sensor life. As the adhesive pad starts to peel off from the skin, movement from the adhesive pad (e.g., from inadvertent pushing or pulling of the mounting unit) can be translated through the length of the sensor to the in vivo portion of the sensor and cause complications and undesired effects. For example, movement translated to the in vivo portion of the sensor can cause irritation and inflammation. In turn, these conditions can cause various forms of wound healing response from the patient's body, all of which can result in sensor inaccuracy, sensor failure, and/or shortened sensor life. If the adhesive pad (and the mounting unit attached thereon) prematurely becomes completely detached from the skin, the sensor, which is attached to the mounting unit, will likely be pulled out of the patient's body, thereby prematurely terminating the sensor session.

(75) When a user begins a new sensor session, it is desirable for that sensor to remain within the host for at least about seven days, preferably at least about 10 days, more preferably at least about 14 days, even more preferably at least about 20 or 21 days, and still even more preferably at least about one month. Without an adhesive pad that is capable of adhering to a patient's skin for the above-described number of days, the sensor may not remain in the host for the desired time. This is problematic because of the inconvenience of having to replace a sensor. If one has to constantly replace sensors because of failure of adhesive pads, this over time can become quite costly to the

user. In the future, the target sensor session length may be even longer. Therefore, there is a need for an adhesive pad system that provides long lasting and stable adherence of the mounting unit to the host's skin. In some embodiments, the adherence is capable of persisting from about ten days to about fourteen days when worn under normal conditions.

(76) Another aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that adhesives present unique design challenges in the context of wearable sensors. For example, as compared to adhesive bandages or other medical patches, the adhesive pad of a wearable sensor has to be capable of supporting the mass and volume of the sensor assembly, and be robust enough to resist pushing and pulling forces on that mass and volume (to resist detachment of the sensor assembly from the skin). Also, in contrast to other conventional patches, bandages, and medical tapes, if the adhesive of the present embodiments fails before a preselected number of days have elapsed since sensor insertion, the wearer cannot simply swap out the failed adhesive pad for another adhesive pad, at least not without possibly destroying the sensor and/or ending the sensor session. But sensors are quite costly. Therefore, it is highly desirable to avoid destroying the sensor before its useful life has elapsed.

(77) Moisture buildup between the wearer's skin and the adhesive pad over-hydrates (macerates) the skin, causing the outer skin layer(s) to shed faster than normal. When the outer layer of the skin sheds, the adhesive pad tends to become detached from the wearer. This premature peel-off of an adhesive pad can be problematic even before the adhesive pad completely detaches from the skin. When the adhesion between the adhesive pad and the skin becomes weak and not sufficiently stable, the electronics housing and the sensor in contact therewith may become susceptible to undesired shaking and movement. Movement at the ex vivo portion of the sensor that contacts the electronics housing can translate across the length of the sensor to the in vivo portion of the sensor and cause complications and undesired effects. For example, movement translated to the in vivo portion of the sensor and cause irritation and inflammation. In turn, these conditions can cause various forms of wound healing response from the patient's body, all of which can result in sensor inaccuracy, sensor failure, and/or shortened sensor life.

(78) Anything that can improve, or at least maintain, skin health helps retain the outer layer(s) of skin, which in turn leads to better long-term adhesion of the sensor system to the wearer. Maintaining normal or near normal breathability for oxygen and moisture transmission through the adhesive pad helps to maintain skin health, and higher MVTR is generally advantageous for longer wear time and better adhesion. Other factors that may improve adhesion include the ability of the adhesive pad to conform to the wearer's skin, and the thickness of the patch.

(79) A. Material Selection

(80) In recognition of the foregoing problem, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems discussed herein, some of the present embodiments may include an adhesive material that is capable of maintaining strong adhesion to the host, even after seven, ten, twelve, fourteen, twenty one, or more days of continuous wear. Such a material can be used to form an adhesive pad capable of adhering to a patient's skin for seven days, ten, twelve, fourteen, twenty-one, or more days, so that the sensor remains the host for the desired number of days. An adhesive pad not capable of providing stable continuous adhesion to the skin for a particular number of days (e.g., 14 days), when the corresponding sensor has a useful life of the aforementioned particular number of days (e.g., 14 days), is problematic because implantable sensors are not without costs. Thus, having to constantly replace sensors designed and approved to work for a particular number of days (e.g., 14 days) prior to that duration can be expensive to the patient and cause great inconvenience.

Described herein are certain embodiments of adhesive pad designs that are configured to provide sufficiently stable support for a mounting unit (e.g., the sensor electronics, such as a transmitter, and the sensor electronics housing) with a mass from about 2 grams to about 15 grams, preferably from about 8 to about 12 grams, and preferably from about 9 to about 11 grams. In addition, certain of the present embodiments described herein are configured to provide sufficiently stable support

for a mounting unit with a sensor electronics housing with a volume from about 500 mm.³ to 2,000 mm.³, preferably from about 800 mm.³ to 1,500 mm.³, and a sensor electronics unit (e.g., transmitter) with a volume from about 1,000 mm.³ to about 7,000 mm.³, and preferably from about 3,000 mm.³ to about 5,000 mm.³. Furthermore, certain of the present embodiments described herein are configured to provide sufficiently stable support for a mounting unit with a maximum height (as measured from a base defined by upper surface of the top layer of the adhesive pad) of from about 3 mm to about 20 mm, preferably from about 7 mm to about 15 mm, and more preferably from about 9 mm to about 12 mm. To provide sufficiently stable support, certain embodiments described herein are configured to resist pushing and pulling forces on the mass and volume of the mounting. The above-described resistance provided by certain embodiments is at a level such that the adhesive pad will substantially remain in place and substantially hold the sensor in place and in the correct alignment when the mounting unit is pulled or pushed through routine incidental contact. As illustrated in FIGS. 42A and 42B, in certain embodiments, the adhesive pad system is configured to resist forces, acting on the adhesive pad system, that are greater than about 6 lbf, greater than about 8 lbf, greater than about 10 lbf, greater than about 11 lbf, greater than about 12 lbf, and greater than about 13 lbf and provide stable sensor performance while the above-mentioned levels of forces are applied thereto. It should be understood that the present embodiments described herein are not limited in their performance capabilities to the metrics (e.g., a certain force resistance and support of a mounting unit with a certain height, mass, volume) described above. Rather, it should be understood that certain embodiments may have performance capabilities that are higher or lower than the metrics described above. By example, in alternative embodiments, the adhesive pad may be configured to support a device with a mounting unit with a mass less than two grams or a mass greater than 15 grams.

(81) An adhesive pad typically comprises a pad, an adhesive that adheres the pad to the skin during use, and one or more backings that are peeled off from an adhesive side of the pad prior to application. The pad may comprise any of a variety of materials, such as, for example, nonwoven spunlace, polyurethane, polyester, and polyethylene. The adhesive layer of the adhesive pad can be formed of any sterile, pressure-sensitive, non-toxic, adhesive suitable for adhesion to healthy human skin. While the adhesive layer adheres to healthy human skin, the adhesive preferably has little or no tendency to adhere to an open wound caused by sensor insertion. Examples of suitable pressure-sensitive adhesives include, but are not limited to, acrylic-based, dextrin-based, urethane-based, rubber-based, polyvinyl-ether-based adhesives, and other adhesives based on natural and synthetic elastomers. Other examples include use of nano/micron scaled textured surfaces for wearable sensor applications. Nano/micron scaled textured surfaces have been demonstrated to provide excellent dry adhesion to contour surfaces.

(82) In selecting an adhesive material, many properties may be considered, such as, and without limitation, adhesive strength, gas permeability, moisture vapor transmission rate (MVTR), appearance (e.g., color, design, texture), tape thickness, elongation, conformability, quality, biocompatibility, manufacturability, and ability to withstand sterilization processes.

(83) Also in recognition of the foregoing problem, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems discussed herein, some of the present embodiments include an adhesive pad having strong adhesiveness with a high peel-off force required to remove the pad from the host. Results of peel tests conducted by the inventors are provided below to quantify the force required to remove selected materials from a test surface.

(84) Adhesive strength or peel adhesion is the force required to remove a pressure sensitive tape from a test panel or its own backing at a controlled angle, at a standard rate, and under standard conditions. The tables below provide test data for peel tests conducted by the inventors to quantify the peel adhesion of example materials that may in some embodiments be used in connection with the adhesive pad system **200**. The test sets are single- or double-sided medical tapes. All tests were

divided into two groups: unsterilized vs. sterilized. All sets were cut into 1"×12" strips and have 1-mil polyester tape on one side. All sets were tested according to the ASTM D3330 standard Test Method A—Single-Coated Tapes, Peel Adhesion at 180° Angle. In accordance with ASTM D3330 standard Test Method A, a strip of tape was rolled mechanically twice in each lengthwise direction, causing the roller to apply the tape to a standard test panel (stainless steel panel). The tape is peeled from the panel at a 180° angle at a specified rate (12 in/min), during which time the force required to effect peel is measured. The average load per width is a value determined using the average load calculated from peeling off the tape from 1" to 3" of the tape's length along with the tape's width.

(85) The average load per width is a calculated value using the average load calculated from 1" to 3" and the specimen width.

(86) TABLE-US-00001 TABLE I Materials Tested Thickness Test Patch Material Description Tape (mil) Qty. 3M 9907W Melt Blown Single-sided 10 10 Polyurethane 3M 9833 Polyurethane Single-sided 2.1 10 3M 9834 Polyurethane Single-sided 1.8 10 3M 1776 Nonwoven Spunlace Single-sided 11.5 10 MacTac TM5300 Polyurethane Single-sided 4 10 MacTac TM5110 Polyurethane Single-sided 2 10 3M 9917 Nonwoven Spunlace Double-sided 12 10 3M 1526 Polyethylene Single-sided 5 10 DM2001 Nonwoven Spunlace Single-sided 10 29 DM2001-C Nonwoven Spunlace Single-sided 10 29

(87) TABLE-US-00002 TABLE II Test Results Test Mean Std Dev Sets Sterilization Qty. (g/inch) (g/inch) 3M 9907W unsterilized 10 1431.65 140.32 3M 9833 unsterilized 10 796.62 45.22 3M 9834 unsterilized 10 569.83 54.20 3M 1776 unsterilized 10 535.81 63.32 MacTac TM5300 unsterilized 10 1207.69 142.19 MacTac TM5110 unsterilized 10 1122.64 50.36 3M 9917 unsterilized 10 697.40 35.86 3M 1526 unsterilized 10 1304.08 76.77 DM2001 unsterilized 29 759.57 81.03 DM2001-C unsterilized 29 777.17 67.14 3M 9907W sterilized 10 1519.53 75.83 3M 9833 sterilized 10 700.23 32.87 3M 9834 sterilized 10 640.70 35.86 3M 1776 sterilized 10 544.31 71.72 MacTac TM5300 sterilized 10 1080.12 86.04 MacTac TM5110 sterilized 10 853.32 41.08 3M 9917 sterilized 10 601.01 45.91 3M 1526 sterilized 10 1570.56 58.56 DM2001 sterilized 29 723.40 74.48 DM2001-C sterilized 29 762.50 73.59

(88) In the foregoing tests, each of the sterilized test samples were subjected to the following sterilization parameters prior to testing: Test samples were e-beam sterilized and each received a dose from about 25 kGy to about 35 kGy.

(89) Another aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that it is advantageous for the adhesive pad to remain adhered to the host's skin for a desired duration, but when it is desired to remove the pad, it is advantageous for the removal process to be quick and comfortable.

Therefore, there is a need for an adhesive pad system that provides long lasting adherence of the mounting unit to the host's skin, but is also easy to remove when desired. Because of the additional mass and weight of the mounting unit (e.g., sensor electronics housing and the electronics disposed thereon), as compared to a conventional medical bandage not designed to be loaded with additional objects, finding the right balance between strong adhesion and ease of adhesive pad removal can be challenging.

(90) In recognition of the foregoing problem, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems discussed herein, some of the present embodiments enable the adhesiveness of the pad to be selectively reduced or deactivated by the wearer. In some embodiments, adhesiveness of the pad is reduced or deactivated by applying a material, such as a solvent (e.g., dipropylene glycol methyl ether, isoparaffin, and isopropyl alcohol), to the pad. Applying such a material facilitates easy removal of the adhesive pad from the host's skin. Thus, when the host desires to remove the adhesive pad, such as at the end of a sensor session, he or she may apply an adhesive reducing material to the pad prior to peeling the pad off his or her skin. Facilitating easy removal of the pad from the skin may help to reduce or eliminate irritation to the host's skin.

(91) In other embodiments, the adhesive pad comprises an adhesive reducing material held in one or more self-contained selectively rupturable reservoirs (e.g., held by encapsulation in

microcapsules). In certain embodiments, one or more adhesion reducing material matrices embedded with the adhesion reducing material are selectively deformable to release the material. The adhesion reducing material may comprise any of a variety of materials capable of reducing the adhesive forces between the wearer's skin and the adhesive pad, thereby reducing pain and body effacement during removal. Examples of adhesion reducing materials include, but are not limited to, oil (e.g., olive oil, safflower oil, cottonseed oil, peanut oil, soybean oil, castor oil, sesame oil, aloe vera, and eucalyptus oil), various forms of hydrocarbons, and solvents (e.g., dipropylene glycol methyl ether, isoparaffin, and isopropyl alcohol) capable of reducing adhesiveness of the adhesive materials described herein.

(92) In certain embodiments, the package provided to patients contains different adhesive pads, each with different adhesive strengths. This arrangement provides users with the opportunity to try various adhesive pads with different adhesives to determine which particular adhesive pad and its corresponding adhesive strength works best. After determining the adhesive pad with the optimal adhesive strength for the user, the user can then order a particular type of package that contains only the selected adhesive pad with the adhesive strength optimized for the user.

(93) In some embodiments, a barrier film is applied to the skin prior to application of the adhesive pad to reduce the likelihood of skin irritation and to make removal of the adhesive pad less painful. The barrier film forms a protective, breathable film barrier between the skin and the adhesive pad. Examples of barrier films include, for example, 3M Cavilon No Sting Barrier Film, ConvaTec AllKare Protective Barrier Wipes, Covidien Webcol Skin Barrier Wipes, and Brava Skin Barrier. In certain embodiments, the barrier film is a sting-free, alcohol-free liquid barrier film that dries quickly to form a breathable, transparent coating on the skin. The barrier film(s) can be breathable and are designed to protect intact or damaged skin from, inter alia, tape trauma, irritation, excoriation, adhesive build-up, and/or friction.

(94) Another aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that the mounting unit of a continuous analyte monitoring system desirably remains secured to the host's skin for several days, including up to fourteen days. Since the adhesive pad at least partially covers the host's skin throughout this period, the pad desirably has high gas permeability. High gas permeability provides several advantages. For example, air circulation close to the host's skin reduces or prevents moisture buildup between the skin and the adhesive pad, which could undermine the effectiveness of the adhesive. Thus, high gas permeability for the adhesive pad may assist in prolonging the lifespan of the adhesive pad. In another example, air circulation through the adhesive pad provides oxygen to the covered area of the host's skin. Therefore, there is a need for an adhesive pad system having high gas permeability. High gas permeability can reduce the risk of premature peel-off. As discussed above, premature peel-off of an adhesive pad can be problematic even before the adhesive pad completely detaches from the skin. When the adhesion between the adhesive pad and the skin becomes weak and not sufficiently stable, the electronics housing and the sensor in contact therewith may become susceptible to undesired shaking and movement. Movement at the ex vivo portion of the sensor that contacts the electronics housing can translate across the length of the sensor to the in vivo portion of the sensor and cause complications and undesired effects. For example, movement translated to the in vivo portion of the sensor and cause irritation and inflammation. In turn, these conditions can cause various forms of wound healing response from the patient's body, all of which can result in sensor inaccuracy, sensor failure, and/or shortened sensor life.

(95) In recognition of the foregoing problem, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems discussed herein, some of the present embodiments are designed to provide improved gas permeability. For example, in some embodiments, at least a portion of the adhesive pad is formed from a suitable porous material, such as, knits, wovens (e.g., cheesecloth and gauze), nonwovens (including spun-bonded nonwovens), extruded porous sheets (e.g., polyurethane), and perforated sheets (e.g., polyurethane), for example. The apertures (e.g., openings) in the porous material are

preferably of sufficient size and sufficient number to facilitate high breathability. The apertures can be through-holes or slit cuts, for example. The size and pitch of the aperture preferably is large enough to allow sweat and moisture from the body to evaporate quickly and effectively. While not wishing to be bound by theory, it is believed that if the size of the apertures is too large water can enter from external sources and the skin will get wet, thereby resulting in weaker adhesive pad adhesion. If the pitch (or the distance from one aperture to the next) is too close, the apertures may weaken the integrity of the adhesive pad system and cause it to tear and break apart. For certain embodiments, the porous materials have between about 1 and about 200 apertures per square centimeter, sometimes between about 25 and about 75 apertures, and other times between about 115 and 175 apertures. In some embodiments, the apertures have an average opening size (the largest dimension of the opening) of at least about 0.01 mm, about 0.05 mm, or about 0.1 mm. For certain embodiments, the apertures have an average opening size (the largest dimension of the opening) of no greater than about 0.05 cm, no greater than about 0.1 cm, or no greater than about 0.5 cm. In some embodiments, the adhesive pad has a Moisture Vapor Transmission Rate (MVTR) between about 1,000 g/24 hrs/m.sup.2 and about 3,000 g/24 hrs/m.sup.2, preferably from about 1,500 g/24 hrs/m.sup.2 to about 2,500 g/24 hrs/m.sup.2, and more preferably from about 2,000 g/24 hrs/m.sup.2 to about 2,300 g/24 hrs/m.sup.2.

(96) In some embodiments, to improve breathability and gas permeability, the adhesive coating applied to the adhesive pad may possess a patterned adhesive coating. Instead of having an adhesive pad with uniform gas permeability across its entire surface, a pattern (e.g., a pattern corresponding to a layout of the pores) may be introduced during coating of an adhesive material onto the pad to provide variations in gas permeability across the pad, for example, in the form of a pattern that promotes breathability while still maintaining sufficient mechanical strength to prevent susceptibility to damage. While not wishing to be bound by theory, it is believed that greater air permeation to the skin will reduce skin cell death rate, which is accelerated when the skin is unable to breathe while covered by a conventional bandage. The dead skin cells, in turn, accumulate into clumps, which in turn, reduces adhesion between the adhesive pad and the skin. By having the above-described materials and/or porous pad design, the skin's ability to "breathe" better is increased, thereby resulting in less dead skin cells and thus a slower death rate. As a result, the useful life of the adhesive pad is increased.

(97) Another aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that, according to current practice, the mounting unit of a continuous analyte monitoring system typically undergoes sterilization after assembly, e.g., after the adhesive pad has been assembled to the mounting unit. One type of sterilization process is electron beam processing, also referred to as electron irradiation or e-beaming. E-beaming is a process involving the use of electrons, usually of high energy, to kill microbes that may be resident on the object being irradiated. The e-beaming process, which may take place under elevated temperature and/or in a nitrogen atmosphere, typically weakens the adhesiveness of the adhesive pad.

(98) In recognition of the foregoing problem, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems discussed herein, some of the present embodiments provide adhesive pad systems having resistance to e-beaming. For example, Table II discloses certain materials that are resistant to decreased adhesiveness after exposure to e-beam sterilization. In some embodiments, an adhesive pad may include a backing layer (the part that is peeled off to expose the adhesive material) having a layer of a material that reflects or redirects the e-beam. Example reflective materials include, without limitation, aluminum foil, biaxially-oriented polyethylene terephthalate (BoPET, available under the trade name MYLAR®), and polytetrafluoroethylene.

(99) In some embodiments, an antiseptic or disinfectant may be incorporated into the adhesive pad. Examples of antiseptics and disinfectants are hexachlorophene, cationic bisguanides (e.g., chlorhexidine, cyclohexidine) iodine and iodophores (e.g., povidoneiodine), para-chloro-meta-xyleneol, triclosan, furan medical preparations (e.g., nitrofurantoin, nitrofurazone), methenamine,

aldehydes (glutaraldehyde, formaldehyde) and alcohols. Other examples of antiseptics and disinfectants will readily suggest themselves to those of ordinary skill in the art.

(100) In certain embodiments, medicament may be incorporated into the adhesive pad, which releases the medicament over time while adhered to the skin. The medicament can be any of a variety of drugs, such as, for example, insulin or other drugs for treating diabetes. To facilitate transdermal passage, different mechanisms and systems may be used, such as e.g. techniques involving formation of microchannels or micropores in the skin, such as e.g. iontophoresis (based on low-level electrical current), sonophoresis (based on low-frequency ultrasound) or microneedling, or the use of drug-carrier agents (e.g. elastic or lipid vesicles such as transfersomes) or permeation enhancers.

(101) It should be understood that any of the materials described herein (e.g., materials for the pad or for the adhesive material) and their associated properties (e.g., resistance to decreased weaknesses as a result of exposure to e-beam sterilization) may be used and/or are applicable to other adhesive sensor systems described herein.

(102) B. Adhesive Sensor Systems

(103) One aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that certain adhesive pads may not remain adhered to the host's skin for a desired duration. For example, when a user begins a new sensor session, it is desirable for that sensor to remain within the host for up to about seven days. In the future, the target sensor session length may be even longer, such as up to about fourteen days or twenty one days. Therefore, there is a need for an adhesive pad system that provides long lasting adherence of the mounting unit (i.e., the wearable ex vivo portion of the sensor system) to the host's skin. In some embodiments, the adherence is capable of persisting for about ten days to about fourteen days.

(104) 1. Replaceable Reinforcing Overlay

(105) In recognition of the foregoing problem, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems discussed herein, some of the present embodiments provide one or more reinforcing overlays covering an adhesive pad. Advantageously, the reinforcing overlay can be periodically replaced if it loses adhesiveness.

(106) FIGS. 2 and 3 illustrate an example embodiment of an adhesive sensor system **200** including a sensor electronics unit **202** secured to an adhesive pad **204** and a replaceable reinforcing overlay **206**. With reference to FIG. 2, the sensor electronics unit **202** is received within an electronics housing **208** that is secured to an upper surface **210** of the adhesive pad **204**. The electronics housing **208** may be secured to the adhesive pad **204** by any of a variety of methods. In one embodiment, the adhesive pad **204** is joined to the electronics housing **208** with glue. In another embodiment, a thermoplastic staking process is used instead. During this process, the electronics housing **208** is heated to a predetermined temperature, which softens the housing **208**. Thereafter, the electronics housing **208** is pressed against an adhesive pad **204** at a predetermined pressure and allowed to cool. Heat-staking is often a preferred technique for adhering the electronics housing to a component of the adhesive pad, because the technique allows for automation, which in turn allows for scaling up. It should be understood that use of heat-staking is not limited to the manufacturing of the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 2, but instead can be used in any of the embodiments described herein.

(107) The adhesive pad **204** is shaped substantially as a thin, flat, sheet that extends beneath the housing **208** and extends outwardly on all sides from a periphery **212** of the electronics housing **208**. The adhesive pad **204** includes at least one opening (not shown) beneath the electronics housing **208**. The sensor (not shown) passes through the opening so that a portion of the sensor extends into the host's skin. In the illustrated embodiment, the adhesive pad **204** is shaped substantially as an oval in plan view, but the illustrated shape is just one non-limiting example. In other embodiments, the adhesive pad may have a shape that is circular, rectangular, square, or any other polygonal shape. In another embodiment, the adhesive pad may have a shape that

corresponds to the shape of the electronics housing, but with dimensions equal to or greater than the corresponding dimensions of the electronics housing **208**.

(108) The adhesive pad **204** comprises a sheet of flexible and resilient material. In some embodiments, the adhesive pad **204** comprises a single layer of material. In other embodiments, the adhesive pad **204** may comprise a plurality of layers. In some of these embodiments, one or more layers can be waterproof or water-resistant, and/or one or more other layers can be moisture absorbent. Example materials for the adhesive pad **204** include, without limitation, fabrics (e.g. spunlace), polymers (e.g., polyurethane, polyethylene, polyester, etc.), film, paper, cotton, silk, and/or any other desired material and combinations thereof. In some embodiments, the adhesive pad **204** can be smooth, but in other embodiments the adhesive pad **204** can be textured. The adhesive pad **204** may be hypoallergenic and/or impregnated with anti-bacterial properties. In some embodiments, the adhesive pad are designed to make the sensor waterproof by using a piece that surrounds a section of the ex vivo portion of the sensor that can be exposed to water. For example, in one embodiment, the adhesive pad includes a silicone O-ring that surrounds a portion of the sensor so that when the adhesive pad is adhered to the skin, a downward force holds the O-ring against the skin and provides a barrier against water entry that may occur from certain activities (e.g., swimming, showering, etc.). Although a silicone O-ring is described, it should be understood that the piece that surrounds the section of the ex vivo portion of the sensor can have any of a variety of shapes (e.g., a polygon) and any of a variety of materials. In another embodiment, a gel (e.g., a silicone gel), adhered on top of the adhesive pad and positioned around the sensor base, is used to provide a waterproof seal around the sensor.

(109) The adhesive pad **204** may also comprise an absorbent layer or absorbents capable of absorbing water and moisture (e.g., sweat). Absorbent materials can include materials such as, but not limited to, a carboxylic acid-containing organic polymer, an amine-containing organic polymer (e.g., poly(quaternary amine), a polylactam, a polyamide), polyethylene terephthalate (PET), polypropylene (PP), or blends of viscose rayon and polyolefins, cellulose fiber, cotton, wool, combinations thereof, or other materials that are absorbent. In some embodiments, the absorbent material will absorb at least 50% of its weight, at least 80% of its weight, or at least 100% of its weight.

(110) An undersurface **214** of the adhesive pad **204** includes an adhesive material, such that the adhesive pad **204** is configured to adhere to the host's skin. The adhesive material on the undersurface **214** of the adhesive pad **204** may comprise any adhesive material, including, but not limited to, any of those described herein, and/or any other material(s) not described herein. The adhesive pad **204** preferably has a slight thickness to enhance the wearability of the pad as well as to render it difficult to peel off the host's skin. For example, the adhesive pad **204** may have a thickness in the range of from about 0.05 mm to about 1 mm, preferably from about 0.1 mm to about 0.7 mm, and more preferably from about 0.2 mm to about 0.5 mm.

(111) With reference to FIGS. **2** and **3**, the adhesive sensor system **200** further comprises a reinforcing overlay **206** that at least partially covers the adhesive pad **204**. FIG. **2** is a partially exploded view that illustrates the overlay **206** separately from the sensor electronics unit **202** and the adhesive pad **204**, while FIG. **3** is an assembled view. With reference to FIG. **2**, the overlay **206** is shaped substantially as a thin, flat, sheet and includes a central opening **216**. The opening **216** is sized and shaped to accommodate the sensor electronics unit **202** so that the overlay **206** can be placed over the adhesive pad **204**, as shown in FIG. **3**. Although illustrated in FIG. **3** with a particular shape, the overlay may have any of a variety of shapes that include straight and/or curved lines. In some embodiments, the opening **216** has a shape that substantially corresponds to the shape of the electronics housing **208**.

(112) The overlay **206** comprises a sheet of flexible and resilient material. Example materials for the overlay **206** include, without limitation, polymers such as polyurethane film and an adhesive material on at least a portion of one or more sides of the polyurethane film. The polyurethane film

can be a breathable material. In example embodiments, the adhesive pad **204** comprises spunlace and the overlay **206** comprises polyurethane.

(113) The overlay **206** has a larger perimeter dimension than the adhesive pad **204**, such that the overlay **206** extends outwardly on all sides from a periphery of the adhesive pad **204** when the overlay **206** is positioned over the adhesive pad **204**, as shown in FIG. 3. It has been found that premature detachment of the adhesive pad is often caused by unintended contact (e.g. rubbing) with the adhesive pad's edge, which is typically the portion of the adhesive pad that is the first to peel off from the skin. It has also been found that greater adhesive pad thickness can result in a greater likelihood of contact, and thus greater likelihood of premature detachment.

(114) To reduce this problem, in some embodiments, a portion of the overlay that comprises the perimeter edge of the overlay has a thickness that is less than that of the interior portion of the overlay. In some embodiments, the perimeter edge of the overlay has a thickness that is less than about 75% of the thickness of the interior portion of the overlay, preferably less than about 50%, and more preferably less than about 25%.

(115) An upper surface **218** of the overlay **206** is non-adhesive, while an undersurface **220** of the overlay **206** includes an adhesive material, such that the overlay **206** is configured to adhere to the host's skin. The adhesive material may cover the entirety of the undersurface **220** of the overlay **206**. Alternatively, the adhesive material may cover only a portion of the undersurface **220** of the overlay **206**. For example, portions of the overlay **206** that abut the adhesive pad **204** in the assembled configuration of FIG. 3 may not include any adhesive material, such that the overlay **206** does not adhere directly to the adhesive pad **204**. The adhesive material on the undersurface **220** of the overlay **206** may comprise any adhesive material, including any of those described herein, and/or any other material(s) not described herein. The overlay **206** preferably has a slight thickness to enhance the wearability of the adhesive sensor system **200** as well as to render it difficult to peel the overlay **206** off the host's skin. For example, the overlay **206** may have a thickness in the range of about 0.01 mm to about 0.1 mm, preferably from about 0.3 mm to about 0.8 mm, and more preferably from about 0.4 mm to about 0.6 mm. As the thickness of the overlay **206** decreases, it becomes more and more difficult to peel off the host's skin. Thus, the overlay **206** is preferably as thin as possible without compromising its ability to reinforce the adherence of the adhesive pad **204** to the host's skin.

(116) In an alternative embodiment, instead of having an overlay **206** designed to adhere to the upper surface **210** of the adhesive pad **204**, the overlay piece (or now more appropriately labeled the underlay) may be designed to be disposed under the adhesive pad **204** during use. The underside of the adhesive pad is then attached to the top surface of the underlay tape. In this embodiment, the underlay (not shown) may not need a central opening **216**. This configuration has several possible advantages. The underside of the adhesive pad can be attached to the upper surface of the underlay. Since the underlay may be formed of a thermoplastic material, such as polyurethane, and the adhesive pad often uses a spun-lace thermoplastic acrylic-based adhesive, this design allows for strong bonding between similar materials. In other words, it leverages the benefits of stronger bond strengths between similar materials. Furthermore, if the underlay is comprised of a thin material, such as polyurethane, the thinner underlay creates a lower edge on the body which reduces mechanical friction or rubbing against the edge of the adhesive patch where most peel failures start. In addition, the underlay, which may be better at adhering to the skin than the adhesive pad, can provide an upper surface for the adhesive pad **204** to adhere to. Through this use, because of improved adherent properties of the underlay, the likelihood of premature detachment by the underlay may be reduced. Although in the embodiments described here, the overlay is applied on top of the adhesive, other configurations are also possible.

(117) As illustrated in FIG. 3, a first portion **222** of the overlay **206** overlies the adhesive pad **204**, and may adhere to the adhesive pad **204**, and a second portion **224** of the overlay **206** lies radially outward of the adhesive pad **204** and may adhere to the skin of the host. In some embodiments, the

first portion **222** may comprise from about 10% to about 75% of the total area of the overlay **206**, and in further embodiments the first portion **222** may comprise from about 15% to about 55% of the total area of the overlay **206**, preferably from about 20% to about 50%. In some embodiments, the adhesive pad **204** may have an area from about 1 square inch to about 2 square inches, such as about 1.6 square inches, and the overlay **206** may have an area from about 4 square inches to about 7 square inches, such as about 5.6 square inches.

(118) The overlay **206** advantageously reinforces the adherence of the adhesive pad **204** to the host's skin. For example, in some embodiments, application of the overlay **206** onto the adhesive pad **204** results in an increased adhesive strength when measured according to average load and maximum load. Tests conducted by the inventors compared the average load and maximum load for a sample set of adhesive pads without reinforcing overlay versus a sample set of adhesive pads with reinforcing overlay.

(119) For the control patches associated with FIG. **42A**, the tests conducted involved the use of Instron 3345 Series Test System. During the test, an assembly comprising an adhesive pad and a sensor electronics unit housing attached thereto are secured to the clamps of the Instron 3345 Series Test System. Securement is achieved by having the clamps grasp the sensor electronics unit housing. Next, the backing layer of the adhesive pad is peeled off and removed. Thereafter, the clamps are lowered to a position (i.e., the initial position) that permits the adhesive pad to be applied and adhered onto a standard test panel (stainless steel panel). Next, the clamps are programmed to raise the assembly at a speed of 12 inches/min. As the clamps are raised, data is collected. The extension described in FIG. **42A** corresponds to the distance moved by the clamps from its initial position. The program provided an output of the maximum and average load (lbf), which correspond to adhesive strength.

(120) For the test patches (i.e., use of a control patch in conjunction with an overlay) associated with FIG. **42B**, the tests conducted also used the Instron 3345 Series Test System. During the test, an assembly comprising an adhesive pad and a sensor electronics unit housing attached thereto are secured to the clamps of the Instron 3345 Series Test System. In addition, an overlay patch is disposed on top of the adhesive pad. Securement is achieved by having the clamps grasp the sensor electronics unit housing. Next, the backing layer of the adhesive pad is peeled off and removed. Thereafter, the clamps are lowered to a position (i.e., the initial position) that permits the adhesive pad to be applied and adhered onto a standard test panel (stainless steel panel). Thereafter, the backing of the overlay patch is removed, and the overlay patch is adhered both to a portion of the adhesive pad and a portion of the standard test panel. Next, the clamps are programmed to raise the assembly at a speed of 12 inches/min. As the clamps are raised, data is collected. The extension described in FIG. **42B** corresponds to the distance moved by the clamps from its initial position. The program provided an output of the maximum and average load (lbf), which correspond to adhesive strength.

(121) Test results, which are provided below and in FIGS. **42A** and **42B**, showed an increase in average load of about 42% and an increase in maximum load of about 17% for the sample set of adhesive pads with reinforcing overlay as compared to the sample set of adhesive pads without reinforcing overlay.

(122) Both control patch and overlay patch samples were tested according to were tested with the method described above, as shown below in Table III. The control patches corresponding to P1 each comprise an adhesive pad and a sensor electronics unit housing attached thereto. Set P2, which used an overlay patch on a control patch, produced higher adhesive strength compared to Set P1 (control patch by itself). FIGS. **42A** and **42B** are plots of extension (inches) vs. load (lbf) generated by Instron BlueHill software. FIG. **42A** illustrates extension vs. load for Set P1, while FIG. **42B** illustrates extension vs. load for Set P2. As shown, there exists a clear difference in the adhesive strength profile between Sets P1 and P2. Both sets reach the maximum adhesive strength around 0.2" of extension and then start to decline. Set P1 continues to decline in adhesive strength

value and finally gives way around 1.0". But in Set P2 the adhesive strength value is maintained from 0.4" to 0.9". From 0.9" the adhesive strength reduces in a step function-like pattern. The adhesive strength of Set P2 does not reach zero until 1.3". The statistical data analysis and adhesive strength profiles suggest that using the overlay patch on the control patch may yield extended adhesion of the control patch on skin as well as provide extra support on patch contact with user skin.

(123) TABLE-US-00003 TABLE III Test Set Description Set Test ID Set Description Sterilization Qty. P1 Control Patch Control Patches are sterilized 30 P2 Control Patch + Control Patches are sterilized. 30 Overlay Patch Overlay Patches are NOT sterilized.

(124) TABLE-US-00004 TABLE IV Avg and Max Adhesive strength (lbf) Set Avg Adhesive strength Max Adhesive strength Test ID (lbf) (lbf) Qty P1 3.935 +/- 0.447 10.504 +/- 1.013 30 P2 5.570 +/- 0.277 12.311 +/- 0.682 30

(125) Further, because the overlay **206** is a separate component from the sensor electronics unit **202** and the adhesive pad **204**, the overlay **206** can be removed at any time and replaced with a fresh overlay **206** without disturbing the continued operation of the sensor electronics unit **202** and without removing the adhesive pad **204** from the host's skin. The overlay **206** can thus serve as an outer, replaceable, sacrificial layer that protects the underlying adhesive pad **204** and prolongs the lifespan of the adhesive pad **204**.

(126) In various embodiments, the shape of the central opening **216** in the overlay **206** may vary. For example, the opening **216** may be shaped to conform to the perimeter shape of any of a variety of different sensor electronics units. Also in various embodiments, the perimeter shape of the adhesive pad **204** and/or the overlay **206** may be a shape other than the illustrated oval shapes, such as circular, or any other polygonal shape. Also in various embodiments, the thickness of the overlay **206** may vary. For example, the overlay **206** may include a lesser thickness in the first portion **222** that directly overlies the adhesive pad **204**, and a greater thickness in the second portion **224** that is positioned radially outward from the adhesive pad **204**, so that the perimeter outline of the adhesive pad **204** is not visible through the overlay **206**. However, in other embodiments, the second portion **224** of the overlay **206** may have a thickness less than that of the first portion **222**, thereby providing a configuration that reduces the likelihood of premature detachment of the overlay **206**, which typically peels off at the perimeter edge.

(127) In various embodiments, the overlay **206** may be transparent or opaque. Also in various embodiments, the adhesive material on the underside **220** of the overlay **206** may be the same as the adhesive material on the underside **214** of the adhesive pad **204**. Alternatively, the adhesive material on the underside **220** of the overlay **206** may be different from the adhesive material on the underside **214** of the adhesive pad **204**. For example, the adhesive material on the underside **220** of the overlay **206** may have stronger or weaker adhesive properties from the adhesive material on the underside **214** of the adhesive pad **204**.

(128) FIGS. 4 and 5 illustrate another example embodiment of an adhesive sensor system **230** including a replaceable reinforcing overlay **232**. The system **230** includes a sensor electronics unit **234**, a sensor electronics unit housing **236** that receives the sensor electronics unit **234**, a frame **238** that receives the housing **236**, and a replaceable reinforcing overlay **232** that seats around the sensor electronics unit **234**, the housing **236**, and the frame **238**, and partially covers the frame **238**. FIG. 4 is an exploded view of the components of the system **230**, while FIG. 5 is an assembled view.

(129) With reference to FIG. 4, the housing **236** comprises a planar bottom wall **240** and a lip **242** that extends around the periphery of the bottom wall **240**. The housing **236** is substantially rectangular in plan view to match the shape of the sensor electronics unit **234**, but could be any shape in other embodiments. The bottom wall **240** includes an opening **244** to accommodate the sensor (not shown), which passes through the opening **244** so that a portion of the sensor extends into the host's skin. A height of the lip **242** is greater than a thickness of the bottom wall **240**, such

that the sensor electronics unit **234** seats within the housing **236** with the underside of the sensor electronics unit **234** abutting the upper face of the bottom wall **240** and the lip **242** extending around the outer edges of the sensor electronics unit **234**, as shown in FIG. 5.

(130) With further reference to FIG. 4, the frame **238** comprises a lip **246** that is sized and shaped to receive the housing **236** with the lip **246** extending around the outer edges of the housing **236**, as shown in FIG. 5. With reference back to FIG. 4, the frame **238** further comprises a flange **248** that extends radially outward from a lower end of the lip **242**. An upper surface **250** of the flange **248** includes texturing **252** that provides improved breathability. In the illustrated embodiment, the texturing **252** comprises a plurality of small apertures arranged substantially in a grid pattern. However, the illustrated configuration of the texturing **252** is just one example and is not limiting.

(131) An undersurface **254** of the housing **236** and/or an undersurface **256** of the frame **238** may include an adhesive material to facilitate securing the adhesive sensor system **230** to the host's skin. The adhesive material may comprise any adhesive material, including any of those described herein, and/or any other material(s) not described herein. The housing **236** and/or the frame **238** may comprise various materials having desired properties, such as, without limitation, flexibility, rigidity, low density, etc. Example materials include, without limitation, polymers such as polycarbonate, polyester, and polyvinyl chloride.

(132) With reference to FIGS. 4 and 5, the overlay **232** at least partially covers the flange **248** of the frame **238**. The overlay **232** is shaped substantially as a thin, flat, sheet and includes a central opening **258**. The opening **258** is sized and shaped to accommodate the sensor electronics unit **234**, the housing **236**, and the frame **238** so that the overlay **232** can be placed over the flange **248**, as shown in FIG. 5.

(133) The overlay **232** comprises a sheet of flexible and resilient material. Example materials for the overlay **232** include, without limitation, fabrics, polymers such as, for example, polyurethane, and other materials that can be formed into a very thin layer.

(134) The overlay **232** has a larger perimeter dimension than the flange **248**, such that the overlay **232** extends outwardly on all sides from a periphery of the flange **248**, as shown in FIG. 5. An undersurface **260** of the overlay **232** includes an adhesive material, such that the overlay **232** is configured to adhere to the host's skin. The adhesive material may cover the entirety of the undersurface **260** of the overlay **232**. Alternatively, the adhesive material may cover only a portion of the undersurface **260** of the overlay **232**. For example, portions of the overlay **232** that abut the flange **248** in the assembled configuration of FIG. 5 may not include any adhesive material, such that the overlay **232** does not adhere directly to the flange **248**. The adhesive material on the undersurface **260** of the overlay **232** may comprise any adhesive material, including any of those described herein, and/or any other material(s) not described herein. The overlay **232** preferably has a slight thickness to enhance the wearability of the adhesive sensor system **230** as well as to render it difficult to peel the overlay **232** off the host's skin. For example, the overlay **232** may have a thickness in the range of about 0.01 mm to about 0.1 mm, preferably from about 0.3 mm to about 0.8 mm, and more preferably from about 0.4 mm to about 0.6 mm. As the thickness of the overlay **206** decreases, it becomes more and more difficult to peel off the host's skin. Thus, the overlay **206** is preferably as thin as possible without compromising its ability to reinforce the adherence of the adhesive pad **204** to the host's skin.

(135) The overlay **232** advantageously reinforces the adherence of the system **230** to the host's skin. Further, because the overlay **232** is a separate component from the sensor electronics unit **234**, the housing **236**, and the frame **238**, the overlay **232** can be removed at any time and replaced with a fresh overlay **232** without disturbing the continued operation of the sensor electronics unit **234** and without removing any other components of the adhesive sensor system **230** from the host's skin. The overlay **232** can thus serve as an outer, replaceable, sacrificial layer that protects the other components and prolongs the lifespan of the system **230**.

(136) In various embodiments, the shape of the central opening **258** in the overlay **232** may vary.

For example, the opening **258** may be shaped to conform to the perimeter shape of any of a variety of different sensor electronics units. Also in various embodiments, the perimeter shape of the flange **248** and/or the overlay **232** may be a shape other than the illustrated rectangular shapes, such as circular, or any other polygonal shape. Also in various embodiments, the thickness of the overlay **232** may vary. For example, the overlay **232** may include a lesser thickness in a portion that directly overlies the flange **248**, and a greater thickness in portions that are positioned radially outward from the flange **248**, so that the perimeter outline of the flange **248** is not visible through the overlay **232**. In various embodiments, the overlay **232** may be transparent or opaque. Also in various embodiments, the adhesive material on the underside **260** of the overlay **232** may be the same as the adhesive material on the underside **254** of the housing **236** and/or the underside **256** of the frame **238**. Alternatively, the adhesive material on the underside **260** of the overlay **232** may be different from the adhesive material on the underside **254** of the housing **236** and/or the underside **256** of the frame **238**. For example, the adhesive material on the underside **260** of the overlay **232** may have stronger or weaker adhesive properties from the adhesive material on the underside **254** of the housing **236** and/or the underside **256** of the frame **238**.

(137) 2. Island Placement

(138) Another aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that a thin adhesive pad that conforms to the contours of the host's skin provides advantages, but can also create discomfort for the host. For example, the sensor electronics unit typically includes a hard plastic outer housing. The thinner the adhesive pad is, the less able it is to provide a cushioning layer between the housing of the sensor electronics unit and the host's skin.

(139) In recognition of the foregoing problem, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems discussed herein, some of the present embodiments provide a multilayer adhesive pad. In one embodiment, the adhesive pad system is configured to support a sensor assembly adhered thereon and is configured to resist pushing and pulling forces on the mass and volume of the sensor assembly. The adhesive pad system is also configured to maintain a sensor insertion for at least 14 days of ambulatory use.

(140) In some embodiments, the multilayer adhesive pad may be configured to provide support and comfort to the patient from a hard plastic sensor electronics housing. The multilayer adhesive pad may comprise one or more layer(s) of spunlace (or another material) that provides a cushioning and comfortable layer that prevents or reduces abrasion of the electronics housing unit against the host's skin, and another layer of the adhesive pad may comprise polyurethane (or another material) to provide strong adhesion with a thin, skin-conforming layer.

(141) FIGS. **6** and **7** illustrate one example embodiment of an adhesive sensor system **270** including a multilayer adhesive pad **272** (FIG. **6**). The system **270** includes a sensor electronics unit **234**, a sensor electronics unit housing **236** that receives the sensor electronics unit **234**, a cushioning layer **274** that seats against the host's skin, an adhesive layer **276** that covers the cushioning layer **274**, and a layer of double-sided tape **278** (FIG. **6**) interposed between the adhesive layer **276** and the sensor electronics unit housing **236**. FIG. **6** is an exploded view of the components of the system **270**, while FIG. **7** is an assembled view.

(142) With reference to FIG. **6**, the sensor electronics unit housing **236** is similar to the sensor electronics unit housing **236** shown and described in preceding embodiments, and therefore will not be further described here. The cushioning layer **274**, the adhesive layer **276**, and the double-sided tape **278** each comprise a thin, flat, sheet of flexible and resilient material. All are substantially rectangular in plan view, but the illustrated shapes are merely examples and are not limiting. The adhesive layer **276** has a larger perimeter dimension than the cushioning layer **274**, and extends outwardly on all sides from a periphery **280** of the cushioning layer **274**, as shown in FIG. **7**. With reference back to FIG. **6**, the double-sided tape **278** has substantially the same size and shape as the sensor electronics unit housing **236** in plan view, and has a smaller perimeter dimension than both the adhesive layer **276** and the cushioning layer **274**. The cushioning layer

274, the adhesive layer **276**, and the double-sided tape **278** each include at least one opening **282**, **284**, **286**, and the openings in each layer **274**, **276**, **278** align with one another when these layers are assembled as in FIG. 7. The sensor (not shown) passes through the aligned openings **282**, **284**, **286** so that a portion of the sensor extends into the host's skin.

(143) The cushioning layer **274** preferably comprises a material that is comfortable to wear directly against skin, and that has sufficient thickness and resilience to provide cushioning between the sensor electronics unit housing **236** and the host's skin. Example materials for the cushioning layer **274** include, without limitation, spunlace (e.g. polyester spunlace), polymers such as polyurethane, fabrics such as non-woven fabrics, and other suitable materials. A thickness of the cushioning layer **274** may be, for example, in the range of 10-12 mils (1 mil=0.001 inches). With reference to FIG. 6, an undersurface **288** of the cushioning layer **274** may include an adhesive material, such that the cushioning layer **274** is configured to adhere to the host's skin. The adhesive material on the undersurface **288** of the cushioning layer **274** may comprise any adhesive material, including any of those described herein, and/or any other material(s) not described herein.

(144) The adhesive layer **276** preferably comprises a material that provides strong adhesion to skin and that has sufficient resilience to closely conform to the contours of the host's skin. Example materials for the adhesive layer **276** include, without limitation, polymers such as polyurethane, fabrics such as non-woven fabrics, and other suitable materials. In example embodiments, the cushioning layer **274** comprises spunlace and the adhesive layer **276** comprises polyurethane. The adhesive layer **276** preferably has a slight thickness to enhance the wearability of the adhesive layer **276** as well as to render it difficult to peel off the host's skin. For example, the adhesive layer **276** may have a thickness in the range of 1-4 mils. An undersurface **290** of the adhesive layer **276** may include an adhesive material, such that the adhesive layer **276** is configured to adhere to the host's skin. The adhesive material on the undersurface **290** of the adhesive layer **276** may comprise any adhesive material, including any of those described herein, and/or any other material(s) not described herein. Example materials for the double-sided tape **278** include 3M® 1567 High Adhesion Double Coated Polyester Medical Tape, and MacTac® TM9720 High Adhesion Double Coated Polyester Medical Tape.

(145) With reference to FIG. 6, opposite facing surfaces **292**, **294** of the double-sided tape **278** include an adhesive material, such that the double-sided tape **278** assists in securing the sensor electronics unit housing **236** to the adhesive layer **276**. The adhesive material of the double-sided tape **278** may comprise any adhesive material, including any of those described herein, and/or any other material(s) not described herein. The opposite facing surfaces **292**, **294** of the double-sided tape **278** may include the same adhesive material, or different adhesive materials. In some embodiments, a spunlace pad having adhesive material on opposite surfaces may be substituted for the double-sided tape **278**.

(146) The adhesive sensor system **270** described above and shown in FIGS. 6 and 7 advantageously combines the cushioning layer **274** with the adhesive layer **276**. The cushioning layer **274** seats directly against the host's skin and provides a comfortable interface between the host and the sensor electronics unit housing **236**, which typically comprises hard plastic. The adhesive layer **276** covers the cushioning layer **274** and provides strong adhesion to the host's skin and also conformity with the skin. The adhesive layer **276** in some embodiments is very thin compared to the cushioning layer **274** and therefore more difficult to peel off from the skin.

(147) FIGS. 8 and 9 illustrate another example embodiment of an adhesive sensor system **300** including a multilayer adhesive pad **302** (FIG. 8). The system **300** of FIGS. 8 and 9 is similar to the system **270** of FIGS. 6 and 7, except for the configuration of the adhesive layer **304**. With reference to FIG. 8, the adhesive layer **304** includes a central opening **306** that is substantially the same size and shape as the double-sided tape **278**. The double-sided tape **278** thus directly abuts and adheres to the cushioning layer **274**, rather than the adhesive layer **304**. This configuration provides added breathability (gas permeability) through the central opening **306** in the adhesive layer **304**, which

can help to reduce moisture buildup between the sensor electronics unit **234** and the host's skin.

(148) In variations of the embodiments of FIGS. **6-9**, the double-sided tape **278** may be omitted. In such variations, the sensor electronics unit housing **236** can be secured to the adhesive layer **276** (FIGS. **6** and **7**) or the cushioning layer **274** (FIGS. **8** and **9**) through any of a variety of techniques, including, for example, transfer adhesive, heat-staking, ultrasonic welding, and others. In the embodiment of FIGS. **8** and **9**, the cushioning layer **274**, which may be a spunlace pad, may have adhesive material on both opposite surfaces **288**, **308** for securing the cushioning layer **274** to the host's skin and for securing the sensor electronics unit housing **236** to the cushioning layer **274**.

(149) FIG. **45** illustrates yet another example embodiment of an adhesive sensor system **450** including a multilayer adhesive pad **452**. The system **450** of FIG. **45** is similar to the system **270** of FIG. **6**, with a difference in the position of the adhesive layer **276** relative to the cushioning layer **274**. With the system **450** illustrated in FIG. **45**, the adhesive layer **276** is positioned below the cushioning layer **274**. The double-sided tape **292** directly adheres to the cushioning layer **274**, rather than the adhesive layer **276**.

(150) In other embodiments, the double-sided tape **292** shown in FIG. **45** may be omitted. In such variations, the sensor electronics unit housing **236** configured to receive the electronics unit **234** can be secured to the adhesive layer **276** and/or the cushioning layer **274** through any of a variety of techniques, including, for example, transfer adhesive, heat-staking, ultrasonic welding, and other techniques. In one embodiment, the cushioning layer **274**, which may be a spunlace pad, may have adhesive material on one or both opposite surfaces for securing the cushioning layer **274** to the adhesive layer **276** and for securing the sensor electronics unit housing **236** to the cushioning layer **274**.

(151) FIGS. **46A-46E** illustrate an example embodiment of an adhesive sensor system **465** along with a liner system that covers a portion of the adhesive sensor system **465** prior to use. The adhesive sensor system may any described herein, including, but not limited to those illustrated in FIGS. **6-9**, **44A**, and **45**. In this particular embodiment, the liner system comprises an upper liner **467**, a bottom folded liner **463**, and a bottom covering liner **461**. FIG. **46A** provides an exploded perspective view of the overall assembly comprising the adhesive sensor system **465** and the liner system, and FIG. **46B** provides an assembled perspective of the assembly of FIG. **46A**. With reference to FIGS. **46B** and **46C**, during use the user first peels off the bottom folded liner **463**. The bottom folded liner only covers a portion of the bottom surface of the adhesive sensor system **465**. Its presence separates a portion of the bottom covering liner **461** from the bottom surface of the adhesive sensor system **465**, thereby making it easier for the user to peel off the bottom covering liner **461**, which has a circumference and surface area that substantially covers the bottom surface of the adhesive sensor system **465**. FIG. **46B** illustrates the assembly prior to the bottom folded liner **463** being peeled off, and FIG. **46C** illustrates the assembly after the bottom folded liner **463** has been peeled. After the bottom folded liner **463** has been peeled off, the user can easily grasp the portion of the bottom covering liner **461** separated from the bottom surface of the sensor adhesive system and remove the bottom covering liner **461** from the bottom surface of the sensor adhesive system **465**. FIG. **46D** illustrates the assembly after the bottom covering liner **461** has been peeled off. Next, the user applies the adhesive sensor system **465** to the skin. Afterwards, the user grasps the portion of the upper liner's peel tab **466** that was earlier bent back, and slowly removes the upper liner **467** from adhesive sensor system **465**, which then remains adhered to the user's skin. The peel tab on the liner can be formed from any of a variety of methods and have any of a variety of configurations. For example, in one embodiment, the peel tab is formed from a cut-out or a perforated line or curve formed on the liner. FIG. **46E** illustrates the assembly after all the liners have been peeled off, leaving only the adhesive sensor system **465**.

(152) Although in the embodiment shown in FIGS. **46A-46E**, the liner system comprises three liners, with two bottom liners and one upper liner, it should be understood that any combination of liners can be used. For example, in one embodiment, the liner system can comprise one upper liner

and one bottom liner. In another embodiment, the liner system can comprise two upper liners (e.g., one that is folded and the other full) and one bottom liner. In yet another embodiment, the liner system can comprise two upper liners and two bottom liners. It should also be understood that the peel tab illustrated in FIGS. 46A-D can be used in any liner. For example, it can be used as an upper liner or a bottom liner.

(153) FIGS. 10-13 illustrate another example embodiment of an adhesive sensor system 320 (FIGS. 12-13) including a multilayer adhesive pad 322. FIG. 10 is an exploded view of the layers of the adhesive pad 322, while FIG. 11 is an assembled view. With reference to FIG. 10, the multilayer adhesive pad 322 includes an inner liner 324, a cushioning layer 326, a reinforcing overlay 328, and an outer liner 330. The cushioning layer 326 and the reinforcing overlay 328 may be similar to the corresponding components described above with respect to the previous embodiments. Therefore, only those characteristics of the cushioning layer 326 and/or the reinforcing overlay 328 that vary from the previous embodiments will be described below.

(154) With continued reference to FIG. 10, the inner liner 324 is a thin, flat, sheet of flexible and resilient material. The inner liner 324 is preferably thin and coated with silicone (or other material with similar properties) on one side only in order to provide easy separation from the patch. Example materials for the inner liner 324 include, without limitation, 3.2 mils siliconized release liner. The inner liner 324 includes an opening 332 that aligns with the opening 334 in the cushioning layer 326 to accommodate the sensor (not shown) so that a portion of the sensor extends into the host's skin. In the illustrated embodiment, the inner liner 324 is shaped substantially as an oval in plan view, but the illustrated shape is just one non-limiting example. An edge of the inner liner 324 includes a protruding tab 336 that provides a convenient location for the host to grasp the inner liner 324 when peeling the adhesive pad 322 off of his or her skin.

(155) An undersurface 338 of the inner liner 324 may include an adhesive material to facilitate securing the adhesive sensor system 320 to the host's skin. The adhesive material may comprise any adhesive material, including any of those described herein, and/or any other material(s) not described herein.

(156) With continued reference to FIG. 10, the outer liner 330 is a thin, flat, sheet of flexible and resilient material. The outer liner 330 is preferably thin and coated with silicone (or other material with similar properties) on one side only in order to provide easy separation from the patch. Example materials for the outer liner 330 include, without limitation, white poly-coated paper carrier having silicone (or other material with similar properties) on one side (4.8 mils/0.12 mm). The outer liner 330 includes a central opening 340 that aligns with the opening 342 in the overlay 328 to accommodate the sensor and to expose a portion of the cushioning layer 326 so that the sensor electronics unit housing (described with respect to subsequent figures) can be secured directly to the cushioning layer 326, as described below. In the illustrated embodiment, the outer liner 330 is shaped substantially as an oval in plan view, but the illustrated shape is just one non-limiting example. The dashed line 343 indicates the location of a peel tab on a backing (not shown) that covers the upper surface of the outer liner 330. Removal of the peel tab 343 from the backing is described below with reference to FIGS. 41A-D, which illustrate one example of a method for securing the outer liner 330 to skin of a wearer.

(157) An undersurface 344 of the outer liner 330 may include an adhesive material to facilitate securing the outer liner 330 to the other layers of the multilayer adhesive pad 322. The adhesive material may comprise any adhesive material, including any of those described herein, and/or any other material(s) not described herein.

(158) With reference to FIGS. 10 and 11, the shapes and sizes of the perimeters of the outer liner 330 and the overlay 328 are substantially identical. Similarly, the inner liner 324 has a perimeter shape that is substantially identical to that of the outer liner 330 and the overlay 328, but slightly larger, as shown in the assembled view of FIG. 11. The inner liner 324 thus extends outwardly on all sides from a periphery of the outer liner 330 and the overlay 328, as shown in FIG. 11. This

feature advantageously protects the edge of the overlay **328** from potential damage from handling. (159) With reference to FIGS. **10** and **11**, the outer liner **330** and the overlay **328** have substantially identical shapes and sizes. A shape of the central openings **340**, **342** in the overlay **328** and the outer liner **330** is substantially identical to, but smaller than, the perimeter shape of the cushioning layer **326**. Thus, when the layers **324**, **326**, **328**, **330** of the multilayer adhesive pad **322** are secured to one another, as shown in FIG. **11**, the outer liner **330** and the overlay **328** overlap the edges of the cushioning layer **326** and leave a central portion **346** of the cushioning layer **326** exposed. As described below, the sensor electronics unit housing is secured to the exposed portion **346** of the cushioning layer **326**.

(160) When all the layers **324**, **326**, **328**, **330** of the multilayer adhesive pad **322** are assembled, as shown in FIG. **11**, the adhesive material on the undersurface **348** (FIG. **10**) of the cushioning layer **326** secures the cushioning layer **326** to the inner liner **324**. Similarly, the adhesive material on the undersurface **350** (FIG. **10**) of the overlay **328** secures the overlay **328** to the cushioning layer **326** and to the inner liner **324**, and the adhesive material on the undersurface **344** (FIG. **10**) of the outer liner **330** secures the outer liner **330** to the overlay **328**. With reference to FIGS. **12** and **13**, the sensor electronics unit housing **352** is secured to the exposed portion **346** of the cushioning layer **326**. FIG. **12** is a partially exploded view that illustrates the sensor electronics unit housing **352** separately from the multilayer adhesive pad **322**, while FIG. **13** is an assembled view.

(161) With reference to FIG. **13**, a footprint of the sensor electronics unit housing **352** is sized to fit within the central openings **340**, **342** of the outer liner **330** and the overlay **328**, such that the undersurface **354** (FIG. **12**) of the sensor electronics unit housing **352** directly abuts only the cushioning layer **326**. The undersurface **354** of the housing **352** may be secured to the cushioning layer **326** using a variety of different techniques. For example, the housing **352** may be secured to the cushioning layer **326** through heat staking. Features on the sensor electronics unit housing **352** can be added to facilitate the bonding method; for example, energy director ridges can be placed at the sites of welding (e.g., ultrasonic welding) or an additional bonding layer can be used to facilitate thermal bonding. During heat staking, a combination of applied conditions (e.g. heat, pressure, and time) are used to melt thermoplastic energy directors to then form a bond to another component upon cooling. To bond a pad to a sensor electronics unit housing, the housing and pad are placed on top of each other. Heat and pressure are then applied for a specified amount of time, melting the housing's energy directors and causing the melted thermoplastic to flow around and among the pad material. When cooled, the housing and pad are bonded together. In another embodiment, bonding of the housing to the adhesive pad is performed by gluing. In still other embodiments, sonic welding (e.g. using high frequency vibration to cause melting), double sided tape, or mechanical methods such as, for example, use of small hooks or hook-and-loop material. Uses of the above-described techniques for bonding the housing to the adhesive pad are not limited to the embodiment illustrated in FIG. **13**, but may be employed in any of the embodiments described herein.

(162) The inner liner **324** may be designed to protect the adhesive on the pads **326**, **328**. In some embodiments, the pad **328** has an extremely thin thickness, such that it has very low rigidity. In such embodiments, without the outer liner **330**, the pad **328** would wrinkle up and stick to itself once the liner **324** is removed. Wrinkling of the pad **328** can result in early peel-off and/or premature detachment of the adhesive pad from the skin. As described elsewhere herein, early peel-off of the adhesive pad can be problematic even before the adhesive pad completely detaches from the skin. When the adhesion between the adhesive pad and the skin becomes weak and not sufficiently stable, the electronics housing and the sensor in contact therewith may become susceptible to undesired shaking and movement. Movement at the ex vivo portion of the sensor that contacts the electronics housing can translate across the length of the sensor to the in vivo portion of the sensor and cause complications and undesired effects. For example, movement translated to the in vivo portion of the sensor and cause complications, such as, irritation and inflammation, for

example. In turn, these conditions can cause various forms of wound healing response from the patient's body, all of which can result in sensor inaccuracy, sensor failure, and/or shortened sensor life. To overcome this problem, an outer liner **330** may be provided to lend additional support to the pad **328**.

(163) FIGS. **41C1-C4** illustrate steps in one example of a method for applying an overlay **4160** over an adhesive pad with a sensor electronics unit housing affixed thereto **4152**. The user is provided with an overlay assembly **4100** comprising an overlay **4160** covered on a first side by an upper liner **4140** and on a second side by a bottom liner **4150**. FIG. **41A** provides an exploded perspective view of the overlay assembly, and FIG. **41B** provides an assembled perspective of the overlay assembly of FIG. **41A**. The overlay **4160** comprises a central opening **4180** in its interior. With reference to FIG. **41C1**, the user bends back the peel tab **4143** formed on the upper liner **4140**. With reference to FIG. **41C2**, the user next grasps the protruding tab **4136** on the bottom liner **4150** and removes the bottom liner **4150** from the remaining portions of the overlay assembly. With reference to FIG. **41C3**, the user next places the remaining portions of the overlay assembly, which now includes the upper liner **4140** and the overlay **4160**, around the sensor electronics unit housing **4152**, such that the central opening **4180** of the overlay **4160** surrounds the sensor electronics unit housing **4152**. The user preferably presses down firmly on the upper liner **4140** to securely adhere the overlay **4160** to the skin. With reference to FIG. **41C4**, the user grasps the portion of the upper liner's **4140** peel tab **4143** that was earlier bent back, and slowly removes the upper liner **4140** from the overlay **4160**, which then remains adhered to the user's skin.

(164) FIGS. **14-17** illustrate another example embodiment of an adhesive sensor system **360** (FIGS. **16-17**) including a multilayer adhesive pad **362**. The system **360** of FIG. **14A** and FIGS. **15-17** is similar to the system **320** of FIGS. **10-13**, except for a change in the configuration of the overlay **364** and the addition of a layer of double-sided tape **366**. With reference to FIG. **14A**, the overlay **364** includes an opening **368** having a substantially smaller size as compared to the embodiment of FIGS. **10-13**. The opening **368** in the overlay **364** is substantially the same size and shape as the openings **332**, **334** in the cushioning layer **326** and the inner liner **324**. The opening **368** in the overlay **364** aligns with the openings **332**, **334** in the cushioning layer **326** and the inner liner **324**, as shown in FIG. **15**, to accommodate the sensor.

(165) Because of the reduced size of the opening **368** in the overlay **364**, the sensor electronics unit housing **352** is not directly secured to the cushioning layer **326**. Rather, with reference to FIGS. **16** and **17**, the layer of double-sided tape **366** secures the sensor electronics unit housing **352** to the overlay **364**. With reference to FIG. **16**, the double-sided tape **366** includes an opening **370** that is substantially the same size and shape as the openings **332**, **334**, **368** in the overlay **364**, the cushioning layer **326**, and the inner liner **324**. The opening **370** in the double-sided tape **366** aligns with the openings **332**, **334**, **368** in the overlay **364**, the cushioning layer **326**, and the inner liner **324** to accommodate the sensor. The double-sided tape **366** includes an adhesive material on its opposite surfaces **372**, **374** (FIG. **14A**) to facilitate securing the sensor electronics unit housing **352** to the overlay **364**. The adhesive material may comprise any adhesive material, including any of those described herein, and/or any other material(s) not described herein. The double-sided tape **366** may include the same adhesive material on both surfaces **372**, **374**, or may include different adhesive materials on its opposite surfaces **372**, **374**. With reference to FIG. **16**, an outer perimeter of the double-sided tape **366** may have a smaller perimeter than the outer perimeter of the sensor electronics unit housing **352**. If the double-sided tape **366** has a tape with a larger outer perimeter (or a tape with the same outer perimeter but is not applied onto the sensor electronics unit housing **352** correctly to prevent an extended edge), the extended edges of the double-sided tape **366** could collect dust and debris. Additionally, the smaller outer perimeter of the double-sided tape **366** allows for manufacturing tolerances.

(166) With reference to FIG. **14A**, the overlay **364** includes an opening **368** having a substantially smaller size as compared to the embodiment of FIGS. **10-13**. The opening **368** in the overlay **364** is

substantially the same size and shape as the openings **332**, **334** in the cushioning layer **326** and the inner liner **324**. The opening **368** in the overlay **364** aligns with the openings **332**, **334** in the cushioning layer **326** and the inner liner **324**, as shown in FIG. **15**, to accommodate the sensor. (167) The embodiment illustrated in FIGS. **14A** and **15-17** provides several advantages. For example, omitting the large central opening in the overlay **364** permits a larger smooth surface area to bond the sensor electronics unit housing **352** to the pad for improved adhesion between the sensor electronics unit housing **352** and the pad. This design also simplifies manufacturing, as compared to a design with a large central opening. The double-sided tape design also provides several advantages. Use of the double-sided tape **366** eliminates the need for a heat stake process. It is generally easier and quicker to bond the sensor electronics housing **352** to the overlay **364** using double-sided tape **366**. Furthermore, it is also easier to automate the process of bonding the sensor electronics unit housing **352** and the overlay **364** together using double-sided tape **366**, as compared to a heat stake process. Furthermore, double-sided tapes are generally inexpensive and simple to form. In addition, waste from defects resulting from manufacturing can be reduced. For example, if the double-sided tape is not applied correctly during manufacturing, it can be simply removed without damaging the adhered parts (e.g., the sensor electronics unit housing). Unlike some other processes described herein (e.g. heat staking), the process of applying double-sided tape is reversible.

(168) In still another embodiment, as illustrated in FIG. **14B**, the adhesive pad **362'** is similar to the adhesive pad **362** illustrated in FIG. **14A**, except for the removal of the double-sided tape **366** from the design and also for a change with regard to having the cushioning layer **326** disposed on top of the overlay **364**, instead of the other way around. With this configuration, the top layer of the adhesive pad **362'** during use (i.e., after removal of the outer liner **330**) is the cushion layer **326**. As described elsewhere herein, in some embodiments, the transmitter housing may be heat-staked to the outermost layer of the adhesive pad. It has been unexpectedly found that certain materials used for the cushioning layer (e.g., a spunlace material or another woven material) provide a better material for heat-staking than certain materials (e.g., polyurethane or other thin polymer materials) used to form the overlay. In addition, because of the use of heat-staking to adhere the sensor electronics housing to the adhesive pad, a double-sided tape, such as the one shown in FIG. **14A** may be omitted, thereby simplifying the adhesive design and reducing the risk of complications.

(169) FIGS. **18-21** illustrate another example embodiment of an adhesive sensor system **380** (FIGS. **20-21**) including a multilayer adhesive pad **382**. The system **380** of FIGS. **18-21** is similar to both the system **320** of FIGS. **10-13** and the system **360** of FIGS. **14-17**. However, with reference to FIG. **18**, the system **380** of FIGS. **18-21** combines the overlay **328** of the system **320** of FIGS. **10-13** and the layer of double-sided tape **366** of the system **360** of FIGS. **14-17**. The double-sided tape **366** thus secures the sensor electronics unit housing **352** to the cushioning layer **326**, as shown in FIGS. **20-21**.

(170) 3. Perforated Overlay

(171) Another aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that removing the overlay covering the inner layer(s) can be challenging. For example, with reference back to FIGS. **2** and **3**, the overlay **206** may begin peeling around the edges before the end of a sensor session. Thus, it is advantageous to remove the overlay and replace it with a fresh overlay so that the current sensor session can be extended. But it can sometimes be difficult to remove the overlay without disturbing the adhesive pad. If the adhesive pad is disturbed during the removal of the overlay, there can be movement that translate from the ex vivo portion of the sensor to the in vivo portion of the sensor. As described elsewhere herein, movement at the ex vivo portion of the sensor that contacts the electronics housing can translate across the length of the sensor to the in vivo portion of the sensor and cause complications and undesired effects. For example, movement translated to the in vivo portion of the sensor and cause complications, such as, irritation and inflammation, for example. In turn, these conditions can cause various forms of wound healing response from the patient's body,

all of which can result in sensor inaccuracy, sensor failure, and/or shortened sensor life.

(172) In recognition of the foregoing problem, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems discussed herein, some of the present embodiments provide an overlay having perforations dividing the overlay into at least two portions. For example, as described in detail below, a first portion of the overlay may be located radially outward from a second portion of the overlay, with a series of perforations forming a border between the first and second portions. When the edges of the first portion of the overlay begin to peel, the first portion may be easily removed by peeling it off the host's skin. The first and second portions separate at the perforations as the first portion is peeled off, leaving the adhesive pad undisturbed. The removed first portion can then be discarded, and a fresh overlay can be applied over the second portion of the first overlay and over the adhesive pad.

(173) It should be understood that perforations can also be used for the adhesive pad. For example, a first portion of the adhesive pad may be located radially outward from a second portion of the adhesive pad, with a series of perforations forming a border between the first and second portions. When the edges of the first portion of the adhesive pad begin to peel, the first portion may be easily removed by peeling it off the host's skin. The first and second portions separate at the perforations as the first portion is peeled off, leaving the second portion of the adhesive pad undisturbed. The removed first portion can then be discarded. In some embodiments, an overlay can then be applied over the second portion of the adhesive pad.

(174) FIGS. **43A** and **43B** illustrate another example embodiment of an adhesive sensor system designed to provide long-term securing of the mounting unit to the skin of the user. In the embodiment shown in FIG. **43A**, the adhesive pad comprises two adhesive layers **4320**, **4350**. However, in other embodiments the adhesive layers can comprise more than two adhesive layers, for example, two, three, four, five, seven, ten, or more adhesive layers. On the top layer **4360**, a base (e.g., the sensor electronics unit housing) is affixed thereto. During use, after removal of a backing layer (not shown) the multilayer adhesive patch **4300** is first adhered to the user's skin. During this time, the first adhesive layer **4350** provides adherence to the skin. Optionally, between the first adhesive layer and the second adhesive layer is a backing layer **4340** for providing some mechanical rigidity or other desired properties to the first adhesive layer **4350**. On top of the backing layer **4340**, an optional low-stick layer **4330** (e.g., a silicone layer) may be provided. The low-stick layer **4330** allows the removal of the first adhesive layer **4350** while the affixed device is kept in place. Preferably, the low-stick will have properties that allow it to keep the two layers together during a period of use (e.g., 5-7 days), while still allowing the peeling off of the first adhesive layer **4350**. After a period of use (e.g., 5-7 days), the first adhesive layer **4350** may start to detach from the skin. At this time, the user can peel off the bottom layer **4370**. While removing the bottom layer **4370** from the skin, the second adhesive layer **4320** becomes exposed and can now be used to adhere to the skin, thereby allowing the device to be worn for an additional period of use (e.g., 5-7 days).

(175) FIGS. **43B** and **43C** illustrate a top and bottom view, respectively, of the adhesive pad **4300**. The top view, as illustrated in FIG. **43B**, shows the patch backing **4310** (e.g., a spunlace material or another woven material) on top of which a base (e.g., the sensor electronics unit housing) is affixed thereto. As illustrated in FIG. **43B**, the adhesive pad **4300** may include a peel-off tab **4380** that may be used to initiate the peeling off of the first adhesive layer **4350**. As illustrated in FIG. **45C**, which provides a bottom view, the first adhesive layer **4350** of the adhesive pad **4300** may have a spiral cut **4390** that allows the first adhesive layer **4350** to be removed in a defined, circling manner.

(176) FIGS. **22-25** illustrate one example embodiment of an adhesive sensor system including a perforated overlay **400** (FIG. **23**). With reference to FIG. **22**, the sensor electronics unit housing **402** and the adhesive pad **404** are illustrated schematically. The adhesive pad **404** is secured to the host's skin (not shown). With reference to FIG. **23**, the overlay **400** is subsequently placed over the adhesive pad **404**. The overlay **400** includes a central opening **406** to accommodate the sensor

electronics unit (not shown) and the sensor electronics unit housing **402**, as shown and described above with respect to previous embodiments.

(177) The overlay **400** includes perforations **408** that mark a boundary between a first radially outward portion **410** and a second inner portion **412**. In some embodiments, the path traced by the perforations **408** may be substantially the same size and shape as the perimeter of the adhesive pad **404**. In other embodiments, the path traced by the perforations **408** may have a larger or smaller perimeter dimension than the adhesive pad **404**, and/or may have a different shape than the adhesive pad **404**.

(178) After the overlay **400** is secured to the host's skin, and as the sensor session progresses over a number of days, the edges of the overlay **400** may begin to peel away from the host's skin. Whenever desired, the host may remove the first (outer) portion **410** of the overlay **400** and discard the first portion **410**. To remove the first portion **410**, the host grasps any edge portion of the overlay **400** and peels it away from the skin. During this process, the first and second portions **410**, **412** of the overlay **400** separate at the perforations **408** due to the strong adhesion of the overlay **400** to the underlying adhesive pad **404**. Thus, after the first portion **410** of the overlay **400** has been removed, the second portion **412** of the overlay **400**, the adhesive pad **404**, and the sensor electronics unit housing **402** remain secured to the host's skin, as shown in FIG. 24. The host may then place a fresh overlay **400'** over the second portion **412** of the first overlay **400** and the adhesive pad **404**, as shown in FIG. 25. The fresh overlay **400'** may remain secured to the host's skin for the remaining duration of the sensor session, thereby prolonging the usable life of the sensor.

(179) In alternative embodiments, the overlay **400** and the adhesive pad **404** may be preassembled, such that the host need not perform the separate steps of applying the adhesive pad **404** to his or her skin and then placing the overlay **400** over the adhesive pad **404**. Instead, the host applies the adhesive pad **404** and the preassembled overlay **400** to his or her skin in a single step.

(180) In the embodiments described above, the overlay **400** includes a radially outward portion **410** that is easy to remove without disturbing the adhesive pad **404**, because the outward portion **410** easily tears away from the inward portion **412** at the perforations **408**. The removed portion can then be discarded, and a fresh overlay **400'** can be applied over the remaining inward portion **412** of the first overlay **400** and over the adhesive pad **404**.

(181) In further alternative embodiments, a single component may be substituted for the overlay **400** and the adhesive pad **404**. For example, the adhesive pad **404** may be extended radially outward and divided into first and second portions by a series of perforations. The separate overlay **400** component may be omitted from such embodiments. The perforated adhesive pad is secured to the host's skin, and when the edges of the perforated adhesive pad begin to peel, the host may remove the first (outer) portion of the perforated adhesive pad by peeling it away from the skin and separating the first and second portions of the perforated adhesive pad at the perforations. The host may then apply a fresh overlay that is substantially the same as the overlay **400'** described in the foregoing embodiment. The overlay would cover the second portion of the perforated adhesive pad, which remains secured to the host's skin, and also provides a radially outward portion that adheres to the host's skin.

(182) In the embodiments described above, the adhesive pad **404** and the overlay **400** both include adhesive material on their respective undersurfaces. In some embodiments, the adhesive material on the adhesive pad **404** may be the same adhesive material as that on the overlay **400**. In other embodiments, the adhesive material on the adhesive pad **404** may be different from the adhesive material on the overlay **400**. For example, the adhesive material on the adhesive pad **404** may be weaker or stronger than the adhesive material on the overlay **400**. In embodiments that include a perforated adhesive pad and no overlay **400**, the inner and outer portions of the perforated adhesive pad may include the same adhesive material or different adhesive materials. For example, the adhesive material on the inner portion of the perforated adhesive pad may be weaker or stronger

than the adhesive material on the outer portion of the perforated adhesive pad.

(183) 4. Adhesive Pad and Overlay Comprising Different Materials

(184) Another aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that different materials in an adhesive sensor system may provide different advantages. For example, fabric materials are well suited for securing the sensor electronics unit housing to the adhesive pad using a heat staking process, while polymeric materials are well suited for strong adhesion to the host's skin using a thin layer that is difficult to peel off.

(185) In recognition of the foregoing aspect, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems and/or aspects discussed herein, some of the present embodiments provide an adhesive pad and an overlay comprising different materials. For example, with reference to FIG. 26, the adhesive pad **420** may comprise a fabric material while the overlay **422** may comprise a polymeric material. The fabric adhesive pad **420** advantageously provides a surface on which the sensor electronics unit housing may be secured using a heat staking process, while the polymeric overlay **422** advantageously provides strong adhesion to the host's skin using a thin layer that is difficult to peel off.

(186) In some embodiments, the adhesive pad may comprise a plurality of layers, with one or more layers formed of a first material configured to provide cushioning for the mounting unit and with one or more layers formed of a third material configured to provide adhesive strength with respect to adhesion to the skin. In further embodiments, the adhesive pad may comprise at least three layers, with each layer formed of a different material. For example, in one embodiment, the adhesive pad comprises a first layer comprising a material configured for heat-staking, a second layer comprising a material configured to provide cushion against the mounting unit to provide patient comfort, and a third layer to provide adhesion strength with respect to adhesion to the skin. In still other embodiments, the adhesive pad may comprise four layers, each formed of a different material and each configured to serve a different function (e.g., for heat-staking, cushioning, wicking, breathability, structural integrity, certain mechanical properties, strong adhesion, etc.)

(187) In any of the embodiments described herein that include an adhesive pad and an overlay, the adhesive pad and the overlay may comprise the same material. For example, the adhesive pad and the overlay may both comprise a polymeric material, such as a transparent polymeric material.

(188) 5. Different Adhesives

(189) Another aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that different adhesive materials may be advantageous for different applications. For example, some hosts may prefer a stronger adhesive for a reduced likelihood of the adhesive peeling off the skin, while other hosts may prefer a weaker adhesive to make it easier to remove the sensor system when desired.

(190) In recognition of the foregoing aspect, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems and/or aspects discussed herein, some of the present embodiments provide an adhesive pad having a plurality of layers, where each layer includes an adhesive material of a different strength.

Furthermore, the present embodiments provide an adhesive configured to provide secured, stable adhesion to the skin (or both the skin and the adhesive pad in the case of the overlay) for at least 7 days, preferably 14 days, and can be easily removed with minimal force. For example, with reference to FIG. 27, the adhesive pad **430** comprises an innermost layer **432**, an outermost layer **434**, and an intermediate layer **436**. Each of the layers **432**, **434**, **436** is coated on its undersurface with a different adhesive material, and/or with the same adhesive material in different strengths. For example, the innermost layer **432** may have the weakest adhesive, the outermost layer **434** may have the strongest adhesive, and the intermediate layer **436** may have an adhesive with a strength somewhere between the weakest adhesive and the strongest adhesive. In another example, the innermost layer **432** may have the strongest adhesive, the outermost layer **434** may have the weakest adhesive, and the intermediate layer **436** may have an adhesive with a strength somewhere between the weakest adhesive and the strongest adhesive.

(191) Each of the layers **432**, **434**, **436** is covered with a removable backing **438**, **440**, **442**, and each backing includes a pull tab **444**, **446**, **448** at its periphery. The host may select one of the innermost layer **432**, the outermost layer **434**, or the intermediate layer **436** for use by pulling a selected one of the pull tabs **444**, **446**, **448**. The host thus may advantageously select a most desired one of the adhesive layers **432**, **434**, **436** based upon personal preference.

(192) In the foregoing embodiments, the provision of three adhesive layers **432**, **434**, **436** is just one non-limiting example. In various embodiments, any number of layers may be provided, including two layers, or four layers, or any other number of layers.

(193) The adhesive pad **430** described above and shown in FIG. **27**, as well as all of the adhesive pads described herein, may be provided as a part of an adhesive sensor system. Such adhesive sensor systems may include any or all of a continuous analyte sensor, a sensor electronics unit, and/or a housing for receiving the sensor electronics unit.

(194) **6. Small Surface Area Adhesive Pad**

(195) Another aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that edges of the adhesive pad tend to fray and/or peel off first, which may cause a cascading effect in which the rate of peel increases. More surface area for the adhesive pad does not necessarily provide better adhesion. In fact, a larger surface area results in a larger perimeter, which can increase the likelihood of the adhesive pad peeling at its edges.

(196) In recognition of the foregoing problem, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems discussed herein, some of the present embodiments provide an adhesive pad with a smaller area than the sensor electronics unit housing. With this arrangement, the adhesive pad is configured to resist early peel-off and premature detachment, because pressure from the sensor electronics unit housing is constant being applied onto the adhesive pad in the direction of skin surface. For example, with reference to FIG. **28**, the adhesive pad **460** is the same shape as the housing **462**, but has a smaller perimeter dimension. In some embodiments, the adhesive pad **460** may have a perimeter dimension that is no larger than 1/32 inch, no larger than 1/16 inch, no larger than 1/8 inch, no larger than 1/4 inch, or no larger than 1/2 inch. The housing **462** thus completely covers the entire perimeter of the adhesive pad **460**, which provides several advantages. For example, the edges of the adhesive pad **460** are recessed behind the perimeter of the housing **462**, and therefore are not susceptible to peeling as a result of friction applied by objects that might otherwise come into contact with the adhesive pad **460**. Further, any downward pressure on the sensor electronics unit housing **462**, which may occur as the host moves about, is translated into pressure on the edges of the adhesive pad **460**, which may further reinforce the bond between the adhesive pad **460** and the host's skin.

(197) **7. Adhesive Pad that does not Require Sterilization**

(198) Another aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that, according to current practice, the mounting unit of a continuous analyte monitoring system typically undergoes sterilization after assembly, e.g., after the adhesive pad has been assembled to the mounting unit. One type of sterilization process is electron beam processing, also referred to as electron irradiation or e-beaming. E-beaming is a process using electrons, usually of high energy, to kill microbes that may be resident on the object being irradiated. The e-beaming process, which may take place under elevated temperature and/or in a nitrogen atmosphere, typically weakens the adhesiveness of the adhesive pad. Therefore, there is a need for an adhesive pad system having resistance to e-beaming or one designed to avoid e-beaming (or other forms of sterilization) all together.

(199) In recognition of the foregoing problem, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems discussed herein, some of the present embodiments provide a continuous analyte monitoring system in which the adhesive pad does not undergo sterilization. For example, the system may include a first assembly comprising an inserter configured to insert a continuous analyte sensor into a host and the continuous analyte sensor itself, which is disposed at least in part in the inserter. The system may include a second assembly, which comprises a mounting unit that

includes an electronics housing and an adhesive pad having an upper surface and an undersurface. The mounting unit is configured to be placed over a host's skin. The electronics housing of the mounting unit is attached to the upper surface of the adhesive pad, and the undersurface of the adhesive pad includes an adhesive material for adhering to the host's skin. The inserter may be configured to insert the continuous analyte sensor into the host. The continuous analyte sensor is disposed in the inserter prior to sensor insertion. In some embodiments, the inserter is configured to be secured to a fastener of the mounting unit prior to sensor insertion. With the above-described design, the mounting unit may be adapted to undergo a different sterilization process than the inserter and/or the continuous analyte sensor. In some embodiments, the mounting unit is designed to not undergo sterilization. During use, the user is provided with the first assembly with an inserter and a sensor disposed therein and with the second assembly that comprises a mounting unit that includes an electronics housing and an adhesive pad. The user then secures the inserter onto the mounting unit. The fastening mechanism may employ any of a variety of techniques for securing components to each other including, but not limited to, bolts, clamps, buckles, hooks, latches, snap fastener, threaded fastener, for example. The fastening mechanism may be designed such that when the inserter is fastened and secured to the mounting unit, the inserter is positioned and oriented in a predetermined configuration (e.g., location and angle) that will allow for suitable sensor insertion. Next, the user employs the inserter to insert the sensor through the skin. After sensor insertion, the user may then unsecure and unfasten the inserter from the mounting unit. Afterwards, in some embodiments, a transmitter or other electronic is placed onto the mounting unit.

(200) In some embodiment, a kit is formed including a first assembly comprising a mounting unit comprising an sensor inserter and a sensor disposed therein and a second assembly comprising a mounting unit configured to fasten onto the inserter prior to sensor insertion. The mounting unit comprises a sensor electronics housing configured to receive a sensor electronics unit (e.g., a transmitter) and an adhesive pad system. In some embodiments, the first assembly may be disposed in a first package and the second assembly may be disposed in a second package. In addition, the first assembly is sterilized, while the second assembly is not sterilized. In one embodiment, the adhesive pad is designed such that sterilization is not required. For example, the adhesive pad may comprise an opening with a boundary that is spaced at distance sufficiently far from the insertion/wound site, such that sterilization is not required. In other words, in this embodiment, there is no contact between the adhesive pad system and the insertion/wound site.

(201) In another example, with reference to FIG. 29, the system 470 may include a mounting frame 472 and a housing 474 that are formed separately from the sensor electronics unit 234. Properties of the mounting frame 472 and/or the housing 474 may be similar to the corresponding components of the embodiment described above and shown in FIGS. 4 and 5. For example, one or both of the mounting frame 472 and the housing 474 may include an adhesive material on their undersurfaces 476, 478. In a process for making the system 470 of FIG. 29, the sensor electronics unit 234 may undergo sterilization, such as an e-beaming process, while the mounting frame 472 and/or the housing 474 do not undergo sterilization. The adhesive material on the mounting frame 472 and/or the housing 474 thus is not subjected to processing that may tend to weaken its adhesiveness. The sensor electronics unit 234 may subsequently be combined with the mounting frame 472 and the housing 474, for example by the host during a process for inserting the sensor into his or her skin. The sensor electronics unit 234 may, for example, be combined with an insertion apparatus, which may also undergo sterilization, either separately or together with the sensor electronics unit 234. In alternative embodiments, the mounting frame 472 and the housing 474 may comprise an integral unit rather than separate components.

(202) While the foregoing embodiment has been described with reference to FIG. 29, the concepts embodied therein are adaptable to any of the other embodiments described herein, as well as to embodiments that are not explicitly described herein but are clearly contemplated by the present disclosure. For example, the concept of sterilizing some components of a continuous analyte

monitoring system and later combining the sterilized components with other components, such as an adhesive pad, that have not been sterilized, is adaptable to other embodiments. Depending on characteristics of the adhesive pad, such as its dimensions, it may be unnecessary to sterilize the adhesive pad, thereby preventing it from risk of damage from sterilization. For example, if the adhesive pad includes an aperture through which the sensor extends into the host's skin, and this aperture is large enough to provide sufficient distance between the sensor insertion site and the adhesive pad, sterilization of the adhesive pad (and the mounting unit attached thereto) may not be necessary.

(203) FIGS. **30-32** illustrate further embodiments of an adhesive sensor system having a cover over the sensor electronics unit. With reference to FIG. **30**, one embodiment of a system **500** includes a sensor electronics unit **502** that is received in a housing **504**. The sensor electronics unit **502** and/or the housing **504** may be similar to the corresponding components of other embodiments described herein. The housing **504** is secured to an adhesive pad **506**, which includes an adhesive material on its undersurface **508** for securing the system **500** to the host's skin (not shown). The adhesive pad **506** and/or the adhesive material may be similar to the corresponding components of other embodiments described herein.

(204) The system **500** further includes a cover **510** that extends over the sensor electronics unit **502**, the housing **504**, and the adhesive pad **506**. As illustrated, a sensor **560** extends from the housing **405** through an opening **562** in the adhesive pad **506** and ultimately through a user's skin during use. Although the sensor is shown to extend from the opening **562** of the adhesive pad **506** at about a 45 degree angle, in other embodiments, the sensor may extend from the opening **562** at any of a variety of angles, such as, a 10 degree angle, a 30 degree angle, a 60 degree angle, a 90 degree angle, a 120 degree angle, a 150 degree angle, or a 170 degree angle, for example. In the illustrated embodiment, the cover **510** includes an arcuate or dome-shaped body that advantageously provides the cover **510** with an unobtrusive profile. However, the illustrated shape is just one non-limiting example. In other example embodiments, the cover may have any shape, such as rectangular.

(205) The cover **510** includes a perimeter surface **512** that abuts an upper surface **514** of the adhesive pad **506** at an outer periphery thereof. This configuration reinforces adhesion of the adhesive pad **506** at the perimeter edge, which is the portion of the adhesive pad that typically is more likely to peel off first. Either one or both of the cover perimeter surface **512** and the adhesive pad upper surface **514** may include an adhesive material to secure the cover **510** and the adhesive pad **506** to one another. The adhesive material(s) may be similar to any of the adhesive materials described herein or may be any other adhesive material(s) not described herein, and the adhesive material on the cover perimeter surface **512** may be the same as or different from the adhesive material on the upper surface **514** of the adhesive pad **506**.

(206) With continued reference to FIG. **30**, an adhesive material **516** may be interposed between an inner surface of the cover **510** and an outer surface of the sensor electronics unit **502**. The cover **510** may thus be secured directly to the sensor electronics unit **502** to enhance the sturdiness of the system **500**. The adhesive material **516** between the cover **510** and the sensor electronics unit **502** may be similar to any of the adhesive materials described herein or may be any other adhesive material not described herein.

(207) FIG. **31** illustrates another embodiment of an adhesive sensor system **520** having a cover **522**. The embodiment of FIG. **31** is similar to the embodiment of FIG. **30**, except that at least a portion of the perimeter surface **524** of the cover **522** is exposed from the adhesive pad **526**. The exposed portion of the cover perimeter surface **524** may include an adhesive material so that the cover **522** can be secured directly to the host's skin. The adhesive material on the cover perimeter surface **524** may be similar to any of the adhesive materials described herein or may be any other adhesive material not described herein.

(208) FIG. **32** illustrates another embodiment of an adhesive sensor system **530** having a cover **532**.

The embodiment of FIG. 32 is similar to the embodiment of FIG. 31, except that the inside of the cover 532 includes structure 534 for mechanically mating with corresponding structure 536 on the sensor electronics unit housing 538. The structure 534, 536 on the housing 538 and the cover 532 may comprise, for example, a tongue and groove, a tab and slot, etc. so that the cover 532 engages the housing 538 with a snap fit. In the illustrated embodiment, the adhesive material interposed between the cover 532 and the sensor electronics unit 540 is omitted. However, in alternative embodiments the adhesive material may be present in addition to the mechanical mating structure 534, 536.

(209) In the embodiments of FIGS. 30-32, the cover 510, 522, 532 advantageously shields and protects the components of the adhesive sensor system 500, 520, 530 from mechanical stresses that may result from being bumped, jostled, etc. The cover 510, 522, 532 also shields and protects the components of the adhesive sensor system 500, 520, 530 from intrusion by moisture, dust, etc. By distributing forces applied to the sensor system 500, 520, 530, the cover 510, 522, 532 may reduce an increase in sensor accuracy following implantation of the sensor. This phenomenon is often referred to as “dip and recover.” A material of the cover 510, 522, 532 may be hard or soft, rigid or flexible, depending upon desired characteristics for a given application. The cover may be constructed of any suitable biocompatible material, such as one or more polymers, metals, ceramics, etc. Non-limiting examples of polymers from which the cover may be constructed include nylon, polyethylene, polyurethane, ethylene-vinyl acetate (EVA), polyether block amide (PEBAX), acrylonitrile butadiene styrene (ABS), polyether ether ketone (PEEK), polytetrafluoroethylene (PTFE), thermoplastic polyetherimide (ULTEM), etc. Non-limiting examples of metals from which the cover may be constructed include stainless steel, titanium, cobalt-chromium, etc. Non-limiting examples of ceramics from which the cover may be constructed include porcelain, alumina, hydroxyapatite, zirconia, etc. The cover may be customizable with graphic prints, patterns, cartoon characters, etc. The cover also may be any color, such as various skin tones to enable the adhesive sensor system to be less conspicuous.

(210) C. Additional Features

(211) 1. Channels and Wicking Material(s)

(212) Another aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that moisture, such as from sweat, typically reduces the adhesiveness of an adhesive pad. This is an important consideration because the adhesive pad of a wearable sensor has to be capable of supporting the mass and volume of the sensor assembly, and be robust to resist pushing and pulling forces on that mass and volume (to resist detachment of the sensor assembly from the skin). Also, in contrast to bandages or other conventional medical tapes, if the adhesive fails before seven days have elapsed since sensor insertion, the wearer cannot simply swap out the failed adhesive pad for another adhesive pad, at least not without destroying the sensor and/or ending the sensor session. But sensors are quite costly. Therefore, it is highly desirable to avoid destroying the sensor before its useful life has elapsed (typically seven days according to the current state of the art).

(213) In recognition of this problem, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems discussed herein, some of the present embodiments provide a wicking material and/or channels to remove moisture from the adhesive pad. These embodiments advantageously enable moisture to be removed from the adhesive pad without needing to remove the adhesive pad from the host. In some embodiments, the adhesive patch comprises a wicking material (e.g., in the form of strands) that accelerate the transport of moisture droplets from the skin to the surface where evaporation would occur more quickly.

(214) FIG. 33 illustrates, schematically, one embodiment of an adhesive pad 550 for an adhesive sensor system, the adhesive pad 550 having a plurality of channels 552 for enabling outflow of moisture. Although in the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 33 uses a channel system with a spoke pattern to move moisture to the edge of the adhesive pad 550, it should be understood that any of a variety of other channel designs that move moisture to the edge or the surface of the adhesive pad

500 are also contemplated. In some embodiments, the channels extend radially outwards to the edge of the adhesive pad. In certain embodiments, one or more channels of the channel system extend outwardly from a center point of the adhesive pad to certain points along the edge of the adhesive pad. In any of the channel systems contemplated herein, the channel can extend either in a straight line, in a substantially straight line, or in a curve.

(215) FIG. **34** is a cross-sectional view of the adhesive pad **550** of FIG. **33**, taken through the line **34-34** in FIG. **33**. With reference to FIG. **34**, the adhesive pad **550** includes a body portion **554** comprising an upper layer **554** of the pad **550**, and an adhesive material **556** comprising a lower layer **556** of the pad **550**. The adhesive material **556**, or lower layer **556**, is configured to abut the host's skin to secure the adhesive pad **550** to the host. The adhesive material **556** may be similar to any of the adhesive materials described herein or may be any other adhesive material not described herein.

(216) With reference to FIGS. **33** and **34**, the adhesive pad **550** further includes a plurality of channels **552**. The channels **552** may be formed in either or both of the body portion **554** (upper layer **554**) and the adhesive material **556** (lower layer **556**). In the illustrated embodiment, the channels **552** extend in a generally radial direction from the center of the adhesive pad **550** to the edges thereof. The channels **552** may extend all the way to the center of the adhesive pad **550**, and may be interconnected, either at a common point of connection at or near the center of the adhesive pad **550**, and/or through additional channels (not shown) that connect adjacent ones of the channels **552** and extend in directions transverse to the radial channels **552**. Similarly, the channels **552** may extend all the way to the edges of the adhesive pad **550**, or may stop short of the edges. The channels **552** may also comprise a combination of channels **552** that extend all the way to either or both of the center and the edges and some channels **552** that do not extend all the way to either or both of the center and the edges. The pattern of channels **552** may be selected to provide a desired moisture channeling behavior.

(217) In some embodiments, the channels **552** may comprise open space, e.g. spaces that are not filled with any solid material. In other embodiments, the channels **552** may comprise one or more wicking materials embedded within the adhesive pad **550**. Wicking materials draw moisture away from the host's skin due to capillary action. Example wicking materials include, without limitation, nitrocellulose, wool, synthetic materials such as polyester, polyethylene, polyethylene terephthalate (PETE), and microfiber-based fabrics. Such wicking material(s) may be prepared with hydrophilic coatings and/or hydrophobic coatings and/or other coatings and chemistries in order to facilitate a desired direction of moisture transpiration. Such wicking material(s) may also be prepared with coatings for the purpose of applying calibration constants and/or medicines for the host. In various embodiments, wicking may be structured in a manner to provide a microfluidic behavior, such as transfer of liquids and/or gases in a single direction by use of channel size and/or surface coatings.

(218) In the above-described embodiments, moisture, such as from sweat, is advantageously transported away from the dermal surface beneath the adhesive pad **550**. The deleterious effects of such moisture, such as compromising the adhesive properties of the adhesive pad **550**, are thereby reduced. Wicking materials and/or channels **552** may additionally be used to apply chemicals and/or other materials to the host's skin without needing to remove the adhesive pad **550** from the skin. Wicking materials that can be used include, for example, nitrocellulose, polyester weave, cotton, linen, and any other material with absorbent properties. Further advantages may include leveraging the wicking behavior to refresh the adhesive by movement of liquid adhesive through the wicking material.

(219) FIG. **44A** illustrates one embodiment of an adhesive sensor system **4400** comprising an electronics unit housing **4420** that has a plurality of channels **4410** on its bottom surface for enabling outflow of moisture. For a better view of the channels **4410**, FIG. **44B** provides a perspective view of the bottom surface of the electronics unit housing **4420**. The top portion of the electronics unit housing **4420** is configured to receive an electronics unit **4480**. Although the

embodiment illustrated in FIG. 44A uses a channel system with a grid-like pattern to move moisture to the edge of the electronics unit housing **4420**, it should be understood that any of a variety of other channel designs that move moisture to the edge electronics unit housing **4420** may also be used. In some embodiments, not shown, the channels **4410** extend from a center portion of the electronics units housing **4420** in a straight line outwards to its edge in a spoke-like pattern. In any of the channel systems contemplated herein, the channel **4410** can extend either in a straight line, in a substantially straight line, or in a curve.

(220) 2. Flexible Applicator

(221) Another aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that for some devices used to secure an adhesive pad of a continuous analyte monitoring system to a host, a rigid applicator surface presses the adhesive pad against the host's skin across the entirety of the adhesive pad. In this process, air bubbles may be trapped between the adhesive pad and the host's skin. These air bubbles provide potential oxidation zones that can reduce the life of the adhesive material on the adhesive pad. The air bubbles also provide boundary edges for the adhesive pad from which lifting of the pad may begin to propagate. All of these potential issues can cause the early peel-off and/or premature detachment of the adhesive pad. Early peel-off and/or premature detachment issues can be more severe, as compared to a simple bandage, because there is a mounting unit attached thereto. The mounting unit adds additional weight and height/volume, which in turn increase the risk of pushing and pulling forces on that mass and volume that can facilitate detachment of the mounting unit/adhesive pad from the skin. In recognition of this problem, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems discussed herein, some of the present embodiments provide an applicator having a flexible surface configured for applying pressure to the adhesive pad. Applying uniform pressure across the surface of the adhesive pad advantageously reduces or prevents formation of air bubbles.

(222) FIGS. **35-40** illustrate, schematically, one embodiment of an applicator device **570** for an adhesive pad of an adhesive sensor system. FIGS. **35-40** show successive stages of a process for securing the adhesive pad to a host's skin **572** using the applicator device **570**. With reference to FIG. **35**, the applicator device **570** comprises an actuator portion **574** and a flexible applicator portion **576** at a distal end of the actuator portion **574**. The actuator portion **574** may comprise, for example, a piston-like member that is translatable within a cylinder **578**. A distal end, or outlet end **580**, of the cylinder **578** includes a reduced diameter as represented schematically by the blocks **582** on either side of the outlet end **580** of the cylinder **578** in FIG. **35**. The reduced diameter may be provided with, for example, an inwardly extending flange at the outlet end **580**. An adhesive pad (not shown) abuts a distal face **584** of the applicator portion **576**, such that actuation of the applicator device **570** applies the adhesive pad to the host's skin **572**, as further described below.

(223) The applicator portion **576** preferably comprises a flexible and resilient material. For example, and without limitation, the applicator portion **576** may comprise silicone, polyamides (e.g. nylon), rubber (e.g. synthetic rubber), polyethylene terephthalate (PET), low-density polyethylene (LDPE), thermoplastic polyurethane, thermoplastic elastomer, and combinations thereof.

(224) With reference to FIG. **36**, in operation of the applicator device **570** the distal end **580** of the cylinder **578** is placed against the host's skin **572**. The actuator portion **574** and the applicator portion **576** then move downward within the cylinder **578** until the applicator portion **576** reaches the distal end **580** of the cylinder **578**, as shown in FIG. **37**. A diameter of the distal face **584** of the applicator portion **576** is slightly greater than a diameter of the outlet end **580** of the cylinder **578**. Thus, as the actuator portion **574** continues moving downward within the cylinder **578**, the applicator portion **576** flexes as shown in FIG. **38** as the actuator portion **574** forces the center of the applicator portion **576** downward while the edge **582** of the outlet end **580** of the cylinder **578** impedes the distal movement of the edges **586** of the applicator portion **576**. The center of the adhesive pad on the distal face **584** of the applicator portion **576** thus contacts the host's skin **572**

first, as shown in FIG. 38. Eventually, the edges 586 of the applicator portion 576 move distally through the outlet end 580 of the cylinder 578, as shown in FIG. 39, due to the temporary reduction in the width of the applicator portion 576 that results from the flexing of the applicator portion 576. As the edges 586 of the applicator portion 576 move distally, the entire adhesive pad is forced against the host's skin 572 in a progression that starts at the center of the adhesive pad and proceeds outward in all directions toward the edges of the adhesive pad. This progression results from the flexing and unflexing of the applicator portion 576 as it is forced through the smaller diameter of the outlet end 580 of the cylinder 578. Eventually, the entire applicator portion 576 emerges from the cylinder 578 and returns to its unstressed shape, as shown in FIG. 40.

(225) The foregoing motion of the applicator portion 576 advantageously reduces or eliminates the formation of air bubbles between the adhesive pad and the host's skin 572. Because the applicator portion 576 flexes as it exits the cylinder 578, the center of the adhesive pad contacts the host's skin 572 first. Then, as the applicator portion 576 flattens out, it pushes the adhesive pad against the host's skin 572 in a smooth progression from the center toward the edges. As the adhesive pad flattens out, it pushes air out of the space between the adhesive pad and the host's skin 572. The reduction or elimination of air bubbles avoids the problems discussed above, such as oxidation zones and boundary edges. Thus, the above-described potential issues (e.g., increased risk of early peel-off and/or premature detachment of the adhesive pad because of a mounting unit attached thereto) are minimized.

(226) In alternative embodiments, the applicator portion 576 may have different shapes than as illustrated in FIGS. 35-40. For example, the applicator portion 576 may have a shape that does not apply pressure to the center, because the adhesive pad may not be present there. The adhesive pad may be, for example, ring shaped such that no portion of the adhesive pad lies over the center of the applicator portion 576. Also in alternative embodiments, the applicator portion 576 may be configured to apply variously directed forces. For example, the applicator portion 576 and/or the system for actuating the applicator portion 576 may be configured to apply force in a radially inward direction, from the perimeter of the applicator portion 576 toward the center. Such an embodiment might be well suited for applying an adhesive pad to the host's skin 572 wherein the adhesive pad has an opening in its center, e.g. a ring-shaped adhesive pad. The opening may be configured to allow for passage of a sensor, for example.

(227) 3. Smearing Adhesive

(228) Another aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that some adhesive pads do not have a flat undersurface (the surface that abuts the host's skin). For example, the adhesive pad may comprise a woven material. For such pads, areas between adjacent fibers may be spaced from the host's skin, and therefore the bond between the adhesive pad and the skin may not be as strong as possible. As described elsewhere herein, a weak bond between the adhesive pad and the skin can result in early peel-off and/or premature detachment of the adhesive pad from the skin. As described elsewhere herein, early peel-off of the adhesive pad can be problematic even before the adhesive pad completely detaches from the skin. When the adhesion between the adhesive pad and the skin becomes weak and not sufficiently stable, the electronics housing and the sensor in contact therewith may become susceptible to undesired shaking and movement. Movement at the ex vivo portion of the sensor that contacts the electronics housing can translate across the length of the sensor to the in vivo portion of the sensor and cause complications and undesired effects. For example, movement translated to the in vivo portion of the sensor and cause complications, such as, irritation and inflammation, for example. In turn, these conditions can cause various forms of wound healing response from the patient's body, all of which can result in sensor inaccuracy, sensor failure, and/or shortened sensor life.

(229) In recognition of this problem, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems discussed herein, some of the present embodiments provide an applicator that applies a laterally directed force, such as a rotational force, as the adhesive pad is pressed against the host's skin to

thereby generate shear force between the adhesive pad and the host's skin. The shear force "smears" the adhesive material, causing it to fill in spaces and push out air bubbles. For example, the applicator portion may follow a small "jog and reverse" path as the adhesive pad is pressed against the host's skin, in which the jog and reverse path is directed laterally across the surface of the host's skin. Alternatively, the applicator portion may undergo a small rotation about an axis normal to the host's skin as the adhesive pad is pressed against the host's skin. These motion paths for the applicator portion may be achieved with guides, rails, or other structure on the apparatus for securing the adhesive pad to the host. In some embodiments, the applicator may be a part of a sensor inserter device that is configured to insert the sensor into the patient, but in other embodiments, the applicator may be a separate device.

(230) 4. Anti-Fraying Edge

(231) Another aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that the edge of the adhesive pad is typically the first portion to peel away from the host's skin. This problem is particularly acute with fabric adhesive pads, which may have threads that have a tendency to fray at the edges. In recognition of this problem, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems discussed herein, some of the present embodiments provide various treatments for reducing the thickness of the edges to resist fraying. By resisting fraying, the useful life of the adhesive pad can be extended to 7 days, 14 days, or preferably longer. In turn, the useful life of the sensor can also be extended to 7 days, 14 days, or preferably longer.

(232) In one example embodiment, pressure and/or elevated temperature may be applied at the edges of the adhesive pad. Pressure may be applied, for example, by passing the adhesive pad, or just the edges of the adhesive pad, through a die to compress the edges. Heat may be applied, for example, to the edges to melt the adhesive pad material and thereby inhibit formation of fine strings that can get caught on clothes or other objects. This embodiment is particularly suited to meltable materials. Other example processes include, without limitation, ultrasonic welding to compress the edges of the adhesive pad, and solvent melting or solvent bonding at the edges of the adhesive pad.

(233) The contour of the adhesive pad and the thickness profile corresponding to the contour may be designed to provide comfort to the wearer without sacrificing susceptibility to premature detachment. It has been found that adhesive pads with increased thickness provide more cushion to skin against the device disposed on the adhesive pad. However, it has also been found that relatively thicker adhesive pads are more susceptible to premature detachment, as compared to relatively thinner adhesive pads. In some embodiments, the perimeter edge of the adhesive pad may have a thickness that is less than the thickness of another portion (e.g. the interior portion(s)) of the adhesive pad. In certain embodiments, the perimeter edge has a thickness that is from about 5% to about 95% of the thickness of the interior, sometimes from about 10% to about 80%, sometimes from about 25% to about 75%, and sometimes from about 33% to about 50%.

(234) 5. Piezochromic Material

(235) Another aspect of the present embodiments involves the realization that inadequate and/or non-uniform pressure applied across the adhesive pad during the process of applying the adhesive pad to the host's skin can result in premature peeling of the adhesive pad from the skin. When insufficient pressure is applied to a section of the adhesive pad, that section may not be properly adhered to the skin. Similarly, if there is substantial non-uniformity in pressure applied across the adhesive pad, certain sections may not adhere well, thereby creating a bulge that is susceptible to early peeling. Thus, it is advantageous to prevent un-depressed areas from forming bulges or bubbles of un-adhered material. In recognition of the foregoing potential complications, as well as in recognition of any of the other advantages or disadvantages discussed herein, some of the present embodiments provide an adhesive pad comprising an indicator that notifies the user whether sufficient pressure has been applied to promote proper adherence of the adhesive pad to the skin. In some embodiments, the indicator may be in the form of a piezochromic material that

changes color when a threshold pressure is applied. The piezochromic material may, for example, be embedded in the adhesive material on the undersurface of the pad.

(236) In one example embodiment, the color changes when a sufficient pressure has been applied. In another embodiment, the material changes to one color (e.g., green) when a desired amount of pressure is applied, and changes to another color (e.g., red) when too much pressure is applied. A lack of color change in the material may indicate that not enough pressure has been applied. The color change may help to ensure that a substantially uniform pressure is applied across the surface of the adhesive pad. In some embodiments, the entire adhesive pad may include the color-changing material. In other embodiments, only certain portions of the adhesive pad (e.g., the edges) may include the color-changing material.

(237) 6. Antimicrobial Material and/or Agents

(238) Another aspect of the present embodiments includes the realization that long-term use of a transcutaneous device may increase the risk of infection. In recognition of this problem, as well as in recognition of any of the other problems discussed herein, some of the present embodiments provide an antimicrobial material integrated into the adhesive pad and/or applied on the surface(s) of the adhesive pad and/or other portions of the adhesive sensor system that are in close proximity to the sensor insertion site. Example antimicrobial materials include, without limitation, silver compounds, copper compounds, zinc compounds, brass compounds, and alloys and/or combinations thereof. Examples include, but are not limited to, silver oxide, silver nitrate, silver acetate, silver lactate, silver sulfate, copper chloride, copper oxide, copper nitrate, copper acetate, copper lactate, copper sulfate, zinc chloride, zinc oxide, zinc nitrate, zinc acetate, zinc lactate, and zinc sulfate. In addition to antimicrobial properties, some of these materials also possess antifungal properties that may provide additional relief to the wearer. The antimicrobial material could, for example, be molded or bonded to the adhesive pad and/or the sensor electronics unit housing. Brass components could also double as temperature transfer points to measure skin surface temperature. In addition to the antimicrobial materials described above (e.g. silver, copper, and zinc compounds), an antimicrobial agent can be incorporated into the adhesive pad. Examples include, but are not limited to, antimicrobial agents such as parachlorometaxylenol, chlorhexidine and salts thereof, iodine, and iodophores, and antibiotics such as neomycin, bacitracin, and polymyxin B.

(239) While various embodiments of the invention have been described above, it should be understood that they have been presented by way of example only, and not by way of limitation. Likewise, the various diagrams may depict an example architectural or other configuration for the disclosure, which is done to aid in understanding the features and functionality that can be included in the disclosure. The disclosure is not restricted to the illustrated example architectures or configurations, but can be implemented using a variety of alternative architectures and configurations. Additionally, although the disclosure is described above in terms of various exemplary embodiments and implementations, it should be understood that the various features and functionality described in one or more of the individual embodiments are not limited in their applicability to the particular embodiment with which they are described. They instead can be applied, alone or in some combination, to one or more of the other embodiments of the disclosure, whether or not such embodiments are described, and whether or not such features are presented as being a part of a described embodiment. Thus the breadth and scope of the present disclosure should not be limited by any of the above-described exemplary embodiments.

(240) It will be appreciated that, for clarity purposes, the above description has described embodiments with reference to different functional units. However, it will be apparent that any suitable distribution of functionality between different functional units may be used without detracting from the invention. For example, functionality illustrated to be performed by separate computing devices may be performed by the same computing device. Likewise, functionality illustrated to be performed by a single computing device may be distributed amongst several computing devices. Hence, references to specific functional units are only to be seen as references

to suitable means for providing the described functionality, rather than indicative of a strict logical or physical structure or organization.

(241) Embodiments of the present disclosure are described above and below with reference to flowchart illustrations of methods, apparatus, and computer program products. It will be understood that each block of the flowchart illustrations, and combinations of blocks in the flowchart illustrations, can be implemented by execution of computer program instructions. These computer program instructions may be loaded onto a computer or other programmable data processing apparatus (such as a controller, microcontroller, microprocessor or the like) in a sensor electronics system to produce a machine, such that the instructions which execute on the computer or other programmable data processing apparatus create instructions for implementing the functions specified in the flowchart block or blocks. These computer program instructions may also be stored in a computer-readable memory that can direct a computer or other programmable data processing apparatus to function in a particular manner, such that the instructions stored in the computer-readable memory produce an article of manufacture including instructions which implement the function specified in the flowchart block or blocks. The computer program instructions may also be loaded onto a computer or other programmable data processing apparatus to cause a series of operational steps to be performed on the computer or other programmable apparatus to produce a computer implemented process such that the instructions which execute on the computer or other programmable apparatus provide steps for implementing the functions specified in the flowchart block or blocks presented herein.

(242) It should be appreciated that all methods and processes disclosed herein may be used in any glucose monitoring system, continuous or intermittent. It should further be appreciated that the implementation and/or execution of all methods and processes may be performed by any suitable devices or systems, whether local or remote. Further, any combination of devices or systems may be used to implement the present methods and processes.

(243) While the disclosure has been illustrated and described in detail in the drawings and foregoing description, such illustration and description are to be considered illustrative or exemplary and not restrictive. The disclosure is not limited to the disclosed embodiments. Variations to the disclosed embodiments can be understood and effected by those skilled in the art in practicing the claimed disclosure, from a study of the drawings, the disclosure and the appended claims.

(244) All references cited herein are incorporated herein by reference in their entirety. To the extent publications and patents or patent applications incorporated by reference contradict the disclosure contained in the specification, the specification is intended to supersede and/or take precedence over any such contradictory material.

(245) Unless otherwise defined, all terms (including technical and scientific terms) are to be given their ordinary and customary meaning to a person of ordinary skill in the art, and are not to be limited to a special or customized meaning unless expressly so defined herein. It should be noted that the use of particular terminology when describing certain features or aspects of the disclosure should not be taken to imply that the terminology is being re-defined herein to be restricted to include any specific characteristics of the features or aspects of the disclosure with which that terminology is associated. Terms and phrases used in this application, and variations thereof, especially in the appended claims, unless otherwise expressly stated, should be construed as open ended as opposed to limiting. As examples of the foregoing, the term 'including' should be read to mean 'including, without limitation,' 'including but not limited to,' or the like; the term 'comprising' as used herein is synonymous with 'including,' 'containing,' or 'characterized by,' and is inclusive or open-ended and does not exclude additional, unrecited elements or method steps; the term 'having' should be interpreted as 'having at least;' the term 'includes' should be interpreted as 'includes but is not limited to;' the term 'example' is used to provide exemplary instances of the item in discussion, not an exhaustive or limiting list thereof; adjectives such as 'known', 'normal',

‘standard’, and terms of similar meaning should not be construed as limiting the item described to a given time period or to an item available as of a given time, but instead should be read to encompass known, normal, or standard technologies that may be available or known now or at any time in the future; and use of terms like ‘preferably,’ ‘preferred,’ ‘desired,’ or ‘desirable,’ and words of similar meaning should not be understood as implying that certain features are critical, essential, or even important to the structure or function of the invention, but instead as merely intended to highlight alternative or additional features that may or may not be utilized in a particular embodiment of the invention. Likewise, a group of items linked with the conjunction ‘and’ should not be read as requiring that each and every one of those items be present in the grouping, but rather should be read as ‘and/or’ unless expressly stated otherwise. Similarly, a group of items linked with the conjunction ‘or’ should not be read as requiring mutual exclusivity among that group, but rather should be read as ‘and/or’ unless expressly stated otherwise.

(246) Where a range of values is provided, it is understood that the upper and lower limit, and each intervening value between the upper and lower limit of the range is encompassed within the embodiments.

(247) With respect to the use of substantially any plural and/or singular terms herein, those having skill in the art can translate from the plural to the singular and/or from the singular to the plural as is appropriate to the context and/or application. The various singular/plural permutations may be expressly set forth herein for sake of clarity. The indefinite article “a” or “an” does not exclude a plurality. A single processor or other unit may fulfill the functions of several items recited in the claims. The mere fact that certain measures are recited in mutually different dependent claims does not indicate that a combination of these measures cannot be used to advantage. Any reference signs in the claims should not be construed as limiting the scope.

(248) It will be further understood by those within the art that if a specific number of an introduced claim recitation is intended, such an intent will be explicitly recited in the claim, and in the absence of such recitation no such intent is present. For example, as an aid to understanding, the following appended claims may contain usage of the introductory phrases “at least one” and “one or more” to introduce claim recitations. However, the use of such phrases should not be construed to imply that the introduction of a claim recitation by the indefinite articles “a” or “an” limits any particular claim containing such introduced claim recitation to embodiments containing only one such recitation, even when the same claim includes the introductory phrases “one or more” or “at least one” and indefinite articles such as “a” or “an” (e.g., “a” and/or “an” should typically be interpreted to mean “at least one” or “one or more”); the same holds true for the use of definite articles used to introduce claim recitations. In addition, even if a specific number of an introduced claim recitation is explicitly recited, those skilled in the art will recognize that such recitation should typically be interpreted to mean at least the recited number (e.g., the bare recitation of “two recitations,” without other modifiers, typically means at least two recitations, or two or more recitations). Furthermore, in those instances where a convention analogous to “at least one of A, B, and C, etc.” is used, in general such a construction is intended in the sense one having skill in the art would understand the convention (e.g., “a system having at least one of A, B, and C” would include but not be limited to systems that have A alone, B alone, C alone, A and B together, A and C together, B and C together, and/or A, B, and C together, etc.). In those instances where a convention analogous to “at least one of A, B, or C, etc.” is used, in general such a construction is intended in the sense one having skill in the art would understand the convention (e.g., “a system having at least one of A, B, or C” would include but not be limited to systems that have A alone, B alone, C alone, A and B together, A and C together, B and C together, and/or A, B, and C together, etc.). It will be further understood by those within the art that virtually any disjunctive word and/or phrase presenting two or more alternative terms, whether in the description, claims, or drawings, should be understood to contemplate the possibilities of including one of the terms, either of the terms, or both terms. For example, the phrase “A or B” will be understood to include the possibilities of “A” or “B” or “A

and B.”

(249) All numbers expressing quantities of ingredients, reaction conditions, and so forth used in the specification are to be understood as being modified in all instances by the term ‘about.’

Accordingly, unless indicated to the contrary, the numerical parameters set forth herein are approximations that may vary depending upon the desired properties sought to be obtained. At the very least, and not as an attempt to limit the application of the doctrine of equivalents to the scope of any claims in any application claiming priority to the present application, each numerical parameter should be construed in light of the number of significant digits and ordinary rounding approaches.

(250) Furthermore, although the foregoing has been described in some detail by way of illustrations and examples for purposes of clarity and understanding, it is apparent to those skilled in the art that certain changes and modifications may be practiced. Therefore, the description and examples should not be construed as limiting the scope of the invention to the specific embodiments and examples described herein, but rather to also cover all modification and alternatives coming with the true scope and spirit of the invention.

Claims

1. An adhesive pad system for securing a continuous analyte sensor assembly to skin of a host, the system comprising: a housing including an outer periphery; an adhesive pad having an upper surface and an undersurface, wherein the housing is secured to the upper surface of the adhesive pad, and wherein the undersurface of the adhesive pad includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the adhesive pad to the skin of the host; an overlay having an upper surface, an undersurface, and a central opening configured to allow at least a portion of the housing to protrude therefrom; a bottom liner configured to cover the undersurface of the overlay, the bottom liner configured to be removed from the undersurface of the overlay; and an upper liner configured to cover the upper surface of the overlay entirely and including a central opening configured to allow at least the portion of the housing to protrude therefrom, wherein the upper liner includes a pull-tab feature formed directly in the upper liner to allow for the upper liner to be removed, and wherein the overlay includes an inner edge bounding the central opening of the overlay and an outer edge at a periphery of the overlay, and wherein the central opening of the overlay is sized such that the inner edge is positioned radially outward of the outer periphery of the housing when the overlay is positioned over the adhesive pad with the housing protruding through the central opening of the overlay, and wherein the undersurface of the overlay includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the overlay to the adhesive pad and to the skin of the host, and wherein the overlay has a larger perimeter dimension than the adhesive pad, such that the overlay extends outwardly on all sides from a periphery of the adhesive pad when the overlay is positioned over the adhesive pad with the housing protruding through the central opening of the overlay, and wherein a first portion of the overlay adheres to the adhesive pad and a second portion of the overlay is adapted to adhere to the skin of the host.

2. The system of claim 1, wherein the first portion of the overlay comprises from about 10% to about 65% of a total area of the overlay.

3. The system of claim 2, wherein the first portion of the overlay comprises from about 20% to about 55% of the total area of the overlay.

4. The system of claim 1, wherein the adhesive pad has an area from about 1 square inch to about 2 square inches.

5. The system of claim 4, wherein the overlay has an area from about 4 square inches to about 7 square inches.

6. The system of claim 1, wherein application of the overlay onto the adhesive pad results in an increased adhesive strength that is from about 40% to about 45% of the adhesive strength of the

adhesive pad alone.

7. The system of claim 1, wherein the overlay is configured to be removed from the adhesive pad and from the skin of the host without disturbing continued operation of a sensor electronics unit that is coupled to the housing.

8. The system of claim 1, further comprising a transcutaneous analyte sensor configured to be coupled to the housing and for extending into the skin of the host.

9. The system of claim 8, wherein the transcutaneous analyte sensor is a transcutaneous glucose sensor.

10. The system of claim 1, wherein the upper liner is more rigid than the overlay.

11. The system of claim 10, wherein the upper liner is more rigid than the bottom liner.

12. The system of claim 1, wherein the upper liner is removably adhered to the upper surface of the overlay.

13. The system of claim 1, wherein the upper liner is configured to inhibit wrinkling of the overlay.

14. A method for securing a continuous analyte sensor assembly to skin of a host, the method comprising: securing the continuous analyte sensor assembly to the skin of the host, wherein the continuous analyte sensor assembly comprises a continuous analyte sensor, an adhesive pad, and a housing, wherein the adhesive pad comprises an upper surface and an undersurface, wherein the housing is secured to the upper surface of the adhesive pad, and wherein the undersurface of the adhesive pad includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the adhesive pad to the skin of the host; providing an overlay, a bottom liner, and an upper liner, wherein the overlay includes an upper surface, an undersurface, and a central opening configured to allow at least a portion of the housing to protrude therefrom, wherein the undersurface of the overlay includes an adhesive material configured to adhere the overlay to the adhesive pad and to the skin of the host, wherein the bottom liner covers the undersurface of the overlay, and the upper liner covers the upper surface of the overlay entirely and includes a central opening configured to allow at least the portion of the housing to protrude therefrom, wherein the upper liner includes a pull-tab feature formed directly in the upper liner to allow for the upper liner to be removed; removing the bottom liner from the undersurface of the overlay; and applying the overlay to the adhesive pad and to the skin when the adhesive pad is adhered to the skin of the host, and wherein the overlay has a larger perimeter dimension than the adhesive pad, such that the overlay extends outwardly on all sides from a periphery of the adhesive pad when the overlay is positioned over the adhesive pad with the housing protruding through the central opening of the overlay, and wherein a first portion of the overlay adheres to the adhesive pad and a second portion of the overlay is adapted to adhere to the skin of the host.

15. The method of claim 14, wherein the first portion of the overlay comprises from about 10% to about 65% of a total area of the overlay.

16. The method of claim 15, wherein the first portion of the overlay comprises from about 20% to about 55% of a total area of the overlay.

17. The method of claim 14, wherein the adhesive pad has an area from about 1 square inch to about 2 square inches.

18. The method of claim 17, wherein the overlay has an area from about 4 square inches to about 7 square inches.

19. The method of claim 14, wherein the upper liner is more rigid than the overlay.

20. The method of claim 19, wherein the upper liner is more rigid than the bottom liner.

21. The method of claim 14, further comprising removing the upper liner from the upper surface of the overlay after the overlay is applied to the adhesive pad and to the skin.

22. The method of claim 14, wherein the upper liner inhibits wrinkling of the overlay.
